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DAUGHTER STOKES ROW

Revanth drops Konda Surekha from Cabinet

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WEST ASIA FLARE-UP

Iran strikes U.S. military bases despite Trump threat

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PACKING A PUNCH

Srikanth knocks out Lai in China Masters

SPORT » PAGE 16

Journalist, feminist icon Gloria Steinem dies at 92

Sunalini Mathew
NEW DELHI

Writer-activist-feminist Gloria Steinem died at her home in New York on Wednesday. She was 92. Through her life, her work, and her words, she spoke for the rights of women. An icon of the second-wave feminist movement in the U.S., she believed women had the right to make decisions on their bodies and reframed abortion as “re-productive freedom”.

She visited India several times since the age of 22, meeting women in villages and cities. In 1972, she co-founded the popular *Ms.* magazine. She died after writing her memoir, *An Unexpected Life*, due for release internationally later this month.



FULL REPORT
» PAGE 14

Bar Council has no power to punish law students: SC

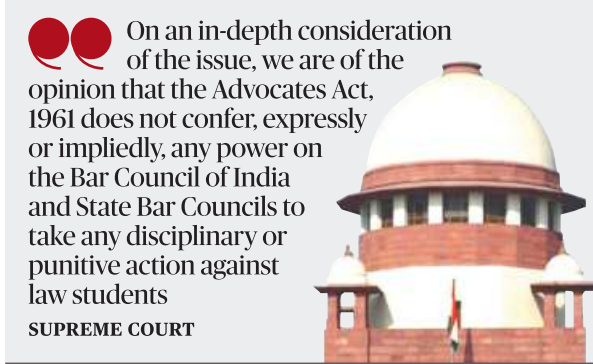
Top court says only the universities they are enrolled in can take action; it rebukes BCI's attempt to intimidate NALSAR students who opposed inviting CJI Kant as chief guest at their convocation

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court on Thursday declared that the Bar Council of India (BCI) and its Chairperson, Manan Kumar Mishra, lack jurisdiction to discipline or penalise law students, rebuking the regulatory body's attempts to intimidate NALSAR students exercising their constitutional right to protest.

The court insisted on clarifying the limits of the BCI's powers though the latter had revoked its August 13 letters to NALSAR administration to launch an inquiry against the students and to the State Bar Councils to block their professional enrolment.

The students had protested against having Chief



On an in-depth consideration of the issue, we are of the opinion that the Advocates Act, 1961 does not confer, expressly or impliedly, any power on the Bar Council of India and State Bar Councils to take any disciplinary or punitive action against law students

SUPREME COURT

Justice Kant as chief guest at their convocation following his oral comments in court comparing youth to “cockroaches” and “parasites”.

Right to dissent

A three-judge Bench headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant said the order, drawing the boundary for the BCI, was designed to

safeguard university space and students' right to freely express dissent against future attempts to breach.

“The BCI has no jurisdiction or statutory competence as regards students. That is for their universities,” Chief Justice Kant observed.

“On an in-depth consideration of the issue, we are of the opinion that the Ad-

vocates Act, 1961, does not confer, expressly or impliedly, any power on the Bar Council of India and State Bar Councils to take any disciplinary or punitive action against law students,” the court recorded in the order.

Mr. Mishra, who was present, said the BCI had a role in regulating legal education. But the court said the BCI could step in only after enrolment. Its disciplinary powers under the Advocates Act, 1961, were, obviously, limited to registered advocates.

“Till then, BCI did not come into the picture... To say a student will not be enrolled...” Justice Joymaya Bagchi said, leaving the sentence unfinished.

CONTINUED ON
» PAGE 10

IN BRIEF



HC dismisses Stalin's plea on Kolathur election

CHENNAI
The Madras High Court has dismissed as not maintainable a writ petition filed by DMK president M.K. Stalin to order the 100% counting of VVPAT slips of the Kolathur Assembly constituency. » **Page 4**

SIR may be legal but is not fair, says former EC

NEW DELHI
The SIR is an example of the “might is right” philosophy being practised by statutory bodies, former Election Commissioner Ashok Lavasa said on Thursday. He said while authorities argue that it is being legally done, “it is definitely not fair”. » **Page 10**

Festive glow



Final touch: An artisan from West Bengal painting eco-friendly Ganesha idols made of clay brought from the banks of the Ganga ahead of Ganesh Chaturthi in One Town, Visakhapatnam, on Sunday. K.R. DEEPAK

GDP revisions: Congress asks govt. to explain methodology

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Congress on Thursday posed four questions to the Central government over the latest GDP estimates and sought an explanation for a cumulative downward revision of ₹43 lakh crore in the estimated size of the Indian economy over the past four years. The party also questioned the methodology used to calculate real growth.

DETAILS ON
» PAGE 11

Holding talks with Punjab, Haryana on tracking stubble fires: air quality panel

Jacob Koshy
NEW DELHI

As part of its preparation to buffer winter pollution in the Delhi National Capital Region (NCR), the Commission for Air Quality Management in NCR and Adjoining Areas (CAQM) has said it is in discussion with authorities in Punjab and Haryana to improve measurement of stubble fires.

“While fire counts reported from satellite passes may not be the most accurate picture of the extent of farm fires, we are in talks with the Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) and Punjab to have better ‘ground truthing’ protocols,” Rajesh Varma, Chairman, CAQM, said at a press briefing on Thursday.

Farm fires in Punjab are a major contributor to pollution during some weeks of October and November



A farmer burning stubble on the outskirts of Chandigarh. FILE PHOTO

when monsoon withdrawal stalls westerly winds that flush out particulate matter pollution from vehicles, industry, agriculture waste, and firecrackers.

In this period, paddy stubble left over after harvesting is frequently burnt to make way for sowing wheat. Over a whole winter, farm fires contribute no more than 15% of the particulate matter pollu-

tion but on certain weeks, this share can spike to almost 44%, several studies have shown.

Mounting evidence

Mr. Varma's comments come in the context of mounting evidence since 2024 that the Punjab government's claims of having reduced farm fires by 90% since 2021 were exaggerated. This is because

these were counted through tracking fires via two satellites passing over India during the day and encouraging several farmers who otherwise face the prospect of fines for being caught setting fire to their fields to burn stubble in the evenings. An ISRO Space Applications Centre study found a gradual shift in peak fire activity from 1.30 p.m. in 2020 to around 5 p.m. in 2024 to avoid detection by polar-orbiting satellites.

“The resolution of satellite sensors matters and the pollution level depends on straw quantity, moisture, combustion efficiency and per-pollutant emission factors that satellites can't measure. But we have asked the ISRO to give us a basic protocol so we can make a start in getting a better estimate than fire counts,” Mr. Varma said.

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LICP/2025-26/34/Eng



Research for Better Medicines

— A Patient Awareness Initiative —

PKD Awareness Day



Research for Better Medicines

— A Patient Awareness Initiative —

A Space Marketing Initiative



Dr. Rajesh B Kumar
Nephrologist

PKD and the Importance of Hope

Polycystic Kidney Disease is a long-term condition, but awareness and medical advances continue to improve understanding of the disease. Today, patients have greater opportunities to learn about PKD, monitor kidney health and discuss treatment options with specialists. The disease progresses differently in different people, making personalised medical care important.

Patients and families should avoid fear-based information and instead rely on qualified healthcare professionals and credible medical sources. World PKD Day provides an opportunity to spread a message of knowledge, support and hope. Greater awareness can encourage timely evaluation, regular follow-up and informed decision-making. The journey may be long, but patients do not have to navigate PKD without information and professional support.

Early Awareness Matters in PKD

Polycystic Kidney Disease making awareness a person may have PKD significant symptoms the disease progresses, and kidney function may pressure is also commonly Individuals with a known speak with a healthcare professional about appropriate evaluation and monitoring. World PKD Day is an opportunity to encourage people not to wait for severe symptoms before paying attention to kidney health. Understanding personal and family risk, monitoring blood pressure, following medical advice and maintaining regular kidney check-ups can help people manage their health journey more proactively.



Dr. Haresh Dodeja
Nephrologist

can progress quietly, critical part of kidney care. without experiencing during the early stages. As kidney cysts can enlarge decline. High blood associated with PKD. family history should

Turning PKD Awareness Into Action

Awareness becomes meaningful when it leads to action. For Polycystic Kidney Disease, action may begin with learning about family history, checking blood pressure regularly and discussing kidney health with a healthcare professional. For diagnosed patients, it includes maintaining follow-up and understanding the treatment plan. Families may also benefit from learning about inherited risk and available support. World PKD Day is an ideal opportunity to move beyond awareness messages and encourage practical steps. Campaigns such as Cyst-Less India can help spread information and encourage patients to seek appropriate care.



Dr. L H Suratkal
Nephrologist

Understanding PKD: A Silent Kidney Disease

Polycystic Kidney Disease (PKD) is a genetic disorder in time, these cysts can enlarge the kidneys and affect their ticed for years, many people are diagnosed only after urinary problems or reduced kidney function. Family histo-generation to another. World PKD Day provides an oppor-disease. Early consultation, appropriate imaging, regular can help patients and families understand the condition



Dr. Hardik Shah
Nephrologist

which multiple fluid-filled cysts develop in the kidneys. Over ability to function normally. Because PKD may remain unno-developing high blood pressure, abdominal discomfort, ry is an important warning sign because PKD can pass from one tunity to increase awareness about this often-overlooked blood pressure monitoring and kidney-function assessment and plan timely care.

Making PKD Care More Accessible

For people living with chronic diseases, access to appropriate treatment and long-term care is an important concern. Polycystic Kidney Disease often requires ongoing monitoring and, for eligible patients, treatment decisions based on disease characteristics and medical guidance. Greater awareness of available options can help patients have informed discussions with their doctors. Efforts to improve affordability and access can further support continuity of care. World PKD Day is therefore not only a time to discuss the disease but also an opportunity to highlight the importance of accessible healthcare. The Cyst-Less India initiative supports the broader goal of improving awareness and encouraging patients to seek appropriate care while working with healthcare professionals throughout their PKD journey.



Dr. Manu Sabu
Nephrologist

Protecting Kidney Health in PKD

Living with Polycystic attention to long-term cannot be understood toms; regular monitoring changes in kidney gradually. Blood priate lifestyle measures follow-up form import-sive care. Doctors may blood pressure and depending on the Treatment decisions should always be individualised by qualified healthcare professionals. World PKD Day reminds patients and families that informed care can make a meaningful difference. Understanding the disease, following medical advice and main-taining regular follow-up can help people stay engaged with their kidney health and manage PKD more confidently.



Dr. Mataf Shafee Farid
Nephrologist

Kidney Disease requires kidney health. PKD only through symp-is important because function may occur pressure control, appro-and scheduled medical ant parts of compreh-monitor kidney function, other aspects of health patient's condition. should always be

PKD: The Need for Continuous Care

Polycystic Kidney Disease is not a condition that should be managed only when symptoms appear. It is a long-term disease that may require continuous monitoring and medical guidance. Kidney function, blood pressure and o t h e r health parameters can change over time. Doctors may adjust care according t o disease progression and individ-ual patient needs. Patients should therefore maintain regular appointments and communicate any new symptoms or concerns. World PKD Day reminds us that continuity of care is an important part of living with PKD. Awareness campaigns can help patients understand why follow-up matters. Consistent medical care, informed deci-sion-making and family support can help indi-viduals navigate the challenges associated with this inherited kidney condition.



Dr. Pooja Kumari
Nephrologist

Why Regular Kidney Check-Ups Matter in PKD

People often associate kidney disease with symptoms cystic Kidney Disease can progress without obvious symp-medical monitoring important for people with a known may assess kidney function, blood pressure and other frequency and type of monitoring depend on personal feeling well does not always mean that kidney health is adherence to an individualised care plan can help patients care decisions.



Dr. Puneet Bhuwania
Nephrologist

such as swelling, fatigue or urinary changes. However, Poly-toms, particularly during earlier stages. This makes regular diagnosis or relevant family history. Healthcare professionals factors to understand an individual's health status. The circumstances. On World PKD Day, the message is clear: unchanged. Regular check-ups, professional guidance and stay informed about their condition and make timely health-

Living With PKD: Knowledge Is Empowerment

A diagnosis of Polycystic Kidney Disease can raise many questions about the future. Patients may wonder how the disease will progress, what monitoring is required and how it may affect family members. These questions deserve clear, evidence-based conversations with healthcare professionals. PKD management may involve monitoring kidney function, controlling blood pressure, addressing symptoms and considering appropriate treatment options for eligible patients. The right approach varies according to individual disease characteristics. On World PKD Day, patients are encour-aged to become active participants in their healthcare journey. Understanding the condition, keeping appointments, following prescribed treatment and discussing concerns openly can help patients feel more informed and confident while living with PKD.



Dr. Rubee Kalita
Nephrologist

Cysts Are Not Always Harmless

The word “cyst” may sound harmless, but in Polycystic Kidney Disease, numerous cysts can progressively affect kidney structure. PKD is different from having an isolated simple kidney cyst. In PKD, cysts can increase in number and size over time and may contribute to complications, including high blood pressure and declining kidney function. Because disease progression varies, medical monitoring is important. People should not attempt to diagnose themselves based on symptoms or internet information. World PKD Day is a reminder to understand the difference and seek professional evaluation when concerns arise. Greater awareness can help individuals recognise family risk, understand their diagnosis and work with healthcare professionals on appropriate long-term management.



Dr. Salman Sayed
Nephrologist

The Importance of Early Medical Consultation in PKD

Polycystic Kidney Disease may develop silently, but that does not mean it should remain unno-ticed. Early medical consultation is particularly important for people who have a family history of PKD or symptoms that may require evalua-tion. Healthcare professionals can determine whether imaging, blood tests, genetic evalua-tion or other assessments are appropriate. Early recognition does not mean that every patient will have the same treat-ment plan. Instead, it provides an opportunity to understand individual risk and monitor health over time. On World PKD Day, communities should be encouraged to take kidney concerns seriously. A conversation with a doctor can be the first step towards understanding PKD and making informed decisions about long-term health.



Dr. Sapta Dipa Das
Nephrologist

World PKD Day: Know PKD, Support Kidney Health

World PKD Day is an opportunity to shine a light on PKD is a genetic condition in which cysts develop and function. Because the disease can remain silent for monitoring are important. People diagnosed with als and follow an individualised care plan. Families appropriate evaluation. Campaigns such as support better access to care. This World PKD Day, tation and build a more PKD-aware India.



Dr. Vaibhav Dharap
Nephrologist

Polycystic Kidney Disease and the families living with it. grow in the kidneys and may gradually affect kidney years, awareness of family history and regular medical PKD should work closely with healthcare profession-can also seek guidance about inherited risk and Cyst-Less India aim to strengthen awareness and let us spread knowledge, encourage timely consul-



Research for Better Medicines

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Research for Better Medicines

— A Patient Awareness Initiative —



Dr Amit Bhat
Urologist

Kidney Stones in ADPKD: Twice as Common, Twice as Tricky

People with ADPKD develop stones about twice as often as the general population—roughly 20% over a lifetime. The reasons include urinary stasis around cysts, low urine pH, and low citrate. Uric acid stones are particularly common. Prevention starts with fluids: aim for at least 2–2.5 liters of urine daily. Dietary salt reduction, weight control, and managing diabetes also help.

When stones cause colic or obstruction, we act quickly—pain control, infection management, and imaging. Procedures like ESWL or PCNL can be effective, but cystic anatomy makes planning crucial. I advise every ADPKD patient with stones to undergo a 24-hour urine test; it guides targeted therapy like potassium citrate or alkalinization. Stones are not inevitable in ADPKD—smart prevention changes the course.

Polycystic Kidneys Don't Just Affect Nephrologists Urologists See Them Daily

Autosomal dominant disease (ADPKD) is “kidney failure” story, we see its everyday urine, stones, and recur-patients first present to or visible hematuria, not Early recognition sound can reveal multi-can rule out infection or patients on hydration, safe pain relief, and when to seek urgent care. ADPKD needs a team—nephrologist, urologist, and family physician—but the urologist is frequently the first to connect symptoms to the underlying disease and start the right conversa-tion.



Dr. Datta Sonwane
Urologist

polycystic kidney often discussed as a but in urology clinics, impact: pain, blood in rent infections. Many us with a painful flank a genetic diagnosis. matters. A simple ultra-ple cysts; a urine test stones. We counsel patients on hydration, safe pain relief, and when to seek urgent care. ADPKD needs a team—nephrologist, urologist, and family physician—but the urologist is frequently the first to connect symptoms to the underlying disease and start the right conversa-tion.

Infected Cysts: The Hidden Cause of UTI That Won't Go Away

Fever, flank pain, and elevated inflammatory mark-ers in ADPKD should raise suspicion for an infected renal cyst—a condition that mimics pyelonephritis but needs different management. Urine cultures may be negative because the infection is inside the cyst. Imaging (CT or MRI) helps localize the culprit cyst. Treatment requires antibiotics that penetrate cysts—fluoroquinolones, TMP-SMX, or macro-lides—for 4–6 weeks, not the usual 3–7 days. If fever persists, drainage or even nephrectomy may be neces-sary. I emphasize: don't stop antibiotics early, even if you feel better. Relapse is common with short courses.



Dr Hemali Trivedi Gupta
Urologist

For recurrent cases, we discuss prophylaxis and, rarely, surgical options. Recognizing infected cysts early prevents sepsis and preserves kidney function. If your “UTI” isn't responding, ask your doctor about cyst infection.

Living Well with ADPKD: A Urologist's Final Advice

ADPKD is lifelong, but it doesn't have to define your life. My low-salt, balanced diet. Know the red flags—fever with flank frequent NSAIDs; use acetaminophen first. Get regular stones or recurrent UTIs, insist on metabolic evaluation and contact sports if you bleed easily. Build a care team you family and support groups. Most importantly, stay informed. care, ADPKD patients live full, productive lives. You are not



Dr Kunal Borade
Urologist

advice: hydrate consistently, control blood pressure, and adopt a pain, persistent hematuria, severe colic—and act early. Avoid check-ups, including urine tests and imaging as advised. For culture-guided treatment. Stay active, but avoid high-impact or trust—nephrologist, urologist, primary doctor—and lean on The 2025 guidelines offer clear, actionable steps. With proactive alone—your urologist is here to help you thrive.

Recurrent UTIs in ADPKD: When "Simple Cystitis" Isn't Simple

Up to half of ADPKD patients will have a urinary tract infection in their lifetime. In women, frequency is higher. The challenge is distinguishing bladder infec-tion from pyelonephritis and, importantly, infected renal cysts. Infected cysts demand longer antibiotic courses and drugs that penetrate cysts—fluoro-quinolones, TMP-SMX, or macrolides—rather than standard short regimens.

I always send a urine culture before starting antibiot-ics, and blood cultures if there's fever or flank pain. Recurrent cases may need prophylaxis, behavioral measures (hydration, post-coital voiding), and occasionally cyst drainage. Cranberry and generous water intake can help prevent recurrences in those with normal kidney function. The message: treat early, treat adequately, and never ignore fever with flank pain in ADPKD—it could be an infected cyst.



Dr. Nikhil Kale
Urologist

When a Stone Becomes an Emergency in Polycystic Kidney Disease

A small stone in a normal in ADPKD, it can precipi-plus infection can rapid-kidney damage. Red fever, vomiting, reduced creatinine. In these We obtain urgent imag-CT), start cultures and press the system—either nephrostomy—before treatment. I counsel have known stones and to pass urine, go to the emergency department immediately. Early decom-pression saves function and lives. After stabilization, we plan definitive management, considering cystic anatomy and residual stone burden. Prevention—hydration, metabolic evaluation, and dietary measures—re-mains the best emergency plan.



Dr. Ojas V Potdar
Urologist

kidney may pass quietly; tate crisis. Obstruction ly lead to sepsis and flags: severe colicky pain, urine output, or rising scenarios, time is kidney. ing (often non-contrast antibiotics, and decom-with a ureteric stent or a definitive stone ADPKD patients: if you develop fever or inability to pass urine, go to the emergency department immediately. Early decom-pression saves function and lives. After stabilization, we plan definitive management, considering cystic anatomy and residual stone burden. Prevention—hydration, metabolic evaluation, and dietary measures—re-mains the best emergency plan.

Blood in the Urine? In ADPKD, It's Common But Not Always Harmless

Seeing red in the toilet is alarming. In ADPKD, gross hematuria occurs in 30–50% of patients, often from a bleeding cyst, a stone, or an infection. Most episodes settle with rest, fluids, and acetamino-p h e n ; NSAIDs like ibuprofen can worsen bleed-i n g and harm kidneys. However, hematu-ria with fever, severe pain, clots, or lasting more than a couple of days needs prompt evalua-tion. We must exclude obstructing stones, infected cysts, and—especially in older patients—urinary cancers. I tell my ADPKD patients: don't panic, but do report it. Keep a record of episodes, triggers, and associat-ed symptoms. This helps us decide when imaging or cystoscopy is needed and ensures we don't miss something serious behind a “typical” bleed.



Dr. Parth Manek
Urologist

Children with ADPKD: Early Urinary Signs Parents Shouldn't Miss

ADPKD isn't just an adult disease. Children can present urine—sometimes before hypertension or kidney fever with urinary symptoms, or visible hematuria. Evalua-metabolic stone workup. We encourage high fluid intake older children. Imaging is preferred over invasive tests simple measures—hydration, prompt treatment of infec-preserve function. Pediatric ADPKD care is a partnership With vigilance, most children do well and transition



Dr. R. D. Hodarkar
Urologist

with urinary symptoms—stones, UTIs, or blood in dysfunction appears. Parents should watch for flank pain, tion includes urine tests, ultrasound, and, when indicated, and low-salt diets early; cranberries may help prevent UTIs in unless complications arise. I tell families: early recognition and tions, and regular follow-up—can prevent scarring and between parents, pediatricians, nephrologists, and urologists. smoothly into adult care.

Living With PKD: Knowledge Is Empowerment



Dr Sumit Mehta
Urologist

A well planned urological strategy reduces post transplant infections, improves graft survival and leads to better quality of life for the patient.

The Role of the Urologist in an ADPKD Care Team

ADPKD care is multidisciplinary: nephrologists manage BP and disease--modifying therapy; geneticists counsel families; radiologists image cysts; urologists handle complications. We intervene for stones, obstructive hematuria, infected cysts, and chronic pain. We perform procedures for cyst aspiration, stone removal, stenting and guide prevention strategies. I collaborate closely with nephrologists: for example, before starting tolvaptan, we ensure no active stones or infec-tions. For transplant candidates, we optimize the urinary tract. Patients often see us during crises; our goal is to turn crises into manageable events through education and timely action. The urolo-gist's role is practical, procedural, and preventive. With a coordinated team, ADPKD patients receive comprehensive care addressing both the genetic disease and its daily urological impacts.



Dr Tarun Jain
Urologist

When to See a Urologist If You Have ADPKD

Not every ADPKD patient needs a urologist immediately, but certain signs warrant referral: recurrent or severe flank pain, visible hematuria (especially with clots or lasting >48 hours), suspected or confirmed kidney stones, recur-rent UTIs (≥3/year), fever with flank pain, or difficulty passing urine. Also seek care if imag-ing shows large, symptomatic cysts or if you're being evaluated for transplant. Early urology input prevents com-plications: we optimize stone prevention, manage infections aggressively, and intervene before obstruction damages kidneys. I encourage patients to establish care before crises occur. Bring prior imaging and lab reports to your first visit. With proactive urolog-ical management, ADPKD patients experience fewer emergencies and better quality of life. Don't wait for the next pain episode schedule a consultation if any of these apply to you.



Dr. Tarun Rochlani
Urologist

ADPKD Pain: Not All Flank Pain Is a Stone

Pain is the most frequent complaint in ADPKD, yet its stone, or infection; chronic pain may stem from enlarged organs. My approach is stepwise: rule out emergencies aminophen first; avoid frequent NSAIDs), and address ed aspiration with sclerotherapy can bring relief. In For chronic pain, we involve pain specialists and diary—timing, triggers, response to meds. This guides drain, a stone we can remove, or a chronic syndrome



Dr. Vaibhao M. Nasare
Urologist

cause varies. Acute pain often signals cyst hemorrhage, a kidneys stretching the capsule or pressing on nearby (obstruction, infected cyst), optimize analgesia (acet-the driver. For large, painful dominant cysts, image-guid-selected cases, laparoscopic cyst decortication helps. consider neuromodulators. I tell patients: keep a pain whether we're dealing with a mechanical issue we can needing multidisciplinary care.

A BM-BME



Welcome move

The relief granted to the Gen Z protesters must not stop with them

In what should be termed a salutary gesture, the Supreme Court of India, at the request of the Union government, invoked its powers under Article 142 of the Constitution to quash criminal cases against the youth who had taken part in nationwide protests seeking examination reforms and government accountability. Led by a group, the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP), in response to Chief Justice of India’s “unemployment” and “cockroaches” remark – these protests swelled in numbers and reach, forcing the then Union Minister of Education, Dharmendra Pradhan, to resign. Among the demands for halting the agitations was the CJP’s call to withdraw the FIRs against protesters in Delhi and other States/Union Territories, which the Court has granted, while directing the Centre to ensure that no fresh FIRs are registered over the protests in July. That the Centre asked for this step by the Court shows how the CJP’s agitations resonated with the youth of the country, who agreed with the movement’s core demands. It is also an acknowledgment by the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP)-led government that this is a pressing issue that revealed its failings, particularly the series of paper leaks across India over the years, compounded by an employment deficit for youth.

The Centre’s stand in the CJP matter is in stark contrast to how it has dealt with dissent on other issues that have driven thousands to protest in recent years. The most prominent among these were the farmer-led protests in and around Delhi, and the agitations against the communally motivated Citizenship (Amendment) Act. Both were largely peaceful, but this did not prevent the government from foisting serious charges including those related to terrorism and sedition, on peaceful protesters, many of whom remain in jail without trial or bail. Legitimate protest has long been a means of defusing pent-up discontent with government policies in India. The Centre has instead sought to criminalise it, branding dissent and disaffection as sedition to create a chilling effect. The CJP managed to overcome that ploy not only through the justness of its demands but also because the protesters’ identities as youth and students transcended the limited categories of religion, caste and even class (“richer farmers”) that the BJP sought to use to sow discord and delegitimise them. Even if it is too much to expect the Centre to seek similar relief for those held in earlier cases, the Court would do well to apply to them the standard it has now set for the CJP. Until it does, the relief granted to the CJP and its sympathisers will remain an exception rather than a principle.

Forging consensus

India must broaden engagement with regional multilateral groups

Prime Minister Narendra Modi’s attendance at the annual meeting of Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO) leaders in Bishkek, Kyrgyzstan, marking 25 years of the Eurasian grouping, had a multi-pronged agenda. This was an occasion to meet his counterparts, for the first time since the U.S.-Israel war on Iran began more than six months ago, which has inflicted economic costs on the whole grouping. The grouping includes Iran, as well as Pakistan that has emerged a mediator between Iran and the U.S., and the Bishkek declaration that condemned the U.S. and Israel’s attacks on Iran and supported Iran’s right to peaceful nuclear technology under the NPT, was significant. Many of the SCO members are also in the BRICS grouping who Mr. Modi will host in Delhi on September 12-13 – this includes Russian President Vladimir Putin, Chinese President Xi Jinping and Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian. New Delhi is keen to forge consensus on a joint declaration, which has been difficult due to UAE-Iran tensions and Mr. Modi’s discussions with Mr. Pezeshkian included BRICS cooperation. India’s ties with the Central Asian Republics have flagged due to other pre-occupations, making Mr. Modi’s visits to Tashkent and Bishkek, and meetings with regional leaders this time, an important initiative to revive talks on trade, critical minerals, tourism and other areas. As Pakistan takes over the SCO chairmanship, the Bishkek Summit allowed Mr. Modi to set out India’s agenda for the coming year. His speech at the Summit focused on the importance of dismantling the ecosystem of “terrorist financing, recruitment, radicalisation, and safe havens”, calling on the SCO to eschew “double standards” on terrorism. He also pressed for a strong message to countries that “use terrorism as an instrument of policy and provide safe haven and support to terrorists” – a pointed reference to India’s oft-repeated concerns about Pakistan. The Bishkek declaration’s inclusion of strong language on “all forms” of terrorism, including cross-border, has thus been welcomed by New Delhi. It remains to be seen how far the Pakistan presidency will take these ideas forward.

Compared to the high-octane optics and the Modi-Putin-Xi handshake at the 2025 Tianjin SCO Summit, this year’s summit was relatively sombre. The U.S.’s tariffs, its war with Iran and sanctions on Russia have damaged economic security, energy security and connectivity (the Hormuz Strait blockade), and pose major challenges to the grouping. For India, after tensions with Pakistan had peaked last year after the Pahalgam attacks and the four-day conflict, the past year has been sobering, given Pakistan’s diplomatic forays with the U.S., and the new security pact with Saudi Arabia and Türkiye. In the altered geopolitical framing, India must seek to broaden its engagement with all regional multilateral organisations such as the SCO.

It is the season of youth in India, without any formal commemorative event to mark it. They are being courted like never before. Political parties across the aisle, Ministries, Departments, think tanks and media organisations of every kind are engaging with the theme of youth. Education and examination systems are being reassessed; skills and coaching processes are under scrutiny; unemployment is being scanned and nuanced.

The whole nation seems occupied with the subject. Political parties are ramping up their conversations on digital platforms, where young people are assumed to reside. Leaders are recasting their hitherto successful models of communication to capture the attention and gain the confidence of Generation Z – the 14-to-29-year-olds – while mimicking their candid vocabulary. College and school campuses are crowded by political personalities. The overstretch almost suggests a desperation to connect.

There have been youth initiatives

Not that the youth have never been cared for. Governments, past and present, have taken up initiatives for youth development. The last 12 years have witnessed a plethora of schemes directed at them, covering employment, entrepreneurship, skill enhancement, education, internships, sports and volunteering. The National Education Policy (NEP) 2020, while facing flak in certain respects, has managed to focus on quality learning geared towards innovation and the empowerment of young citizens. The proposed National Youth Policy 2026 seeks to prepare those in the 15-29 age group for the new digital age.

But beyond the good schemes, there is a lag in understanding Gen Z and Gen A (those born after 2010), who have begun to demand accountability. A NITI Aayog report speaks of 8.7 crore people in the 15-29 age group who are ‘not in education, employment or training’ (NEET). Despite clarifications from the government that NEET does not necessarily mean joblessness, a staggering amount of youthful energy still awaits an anchor. The yawning gap between formal degrees and job prospects remains a daunting problem. In the wake of the recent street protests, the Opposition has built a narrative that the ruling dispensation is hostile to younger generations. The question is: do they have a blueprint for the country’s youth, or are they only making political capital out of the current ferment?



Akshay Rout

Former Director General, Election Commission of India, and a public policy commentator

India’s Gen Z is gaining political attention, but is yet to consolidate into a viable electoral bloc

Not taking away from the goodwill of political entities towards the nation’s future generations, the overwhelming context is the chorus orchestrated by the country’s youth in Delhi and other places in recent weeks. While the youth furore and its consequences in India bear no comparison with the cataclysmic happenings in parts of the South Asian neighbourhood, a wake-up call has been sounded to those in power and those seeking to get there. The response, however exaggerated, is welcome. Parties and leaders now appear to be grappling with issues concerning the youth, regardless of whether they are motivated by electoral politics.

More an elusive vote

India has the largest youth population in the world; 65% of its nearly 1.5 billion people are below 35 years of age. About 23% of the country’s electorate falls in the 18-29 age category. In elections in recent years, including the latest Assembly elections in Tamil Nadu, Assam, West Bengal, Kerala and Puducherry, there was no discernible trend of young people voting in any political direction. The outcome in Tamil Nadu showed some hints of youth consolidation, but it was far from being based on any alternative youth agenda. In last year’s Bihar election, noticeable efforts by political groups to advance a youth agenda did not generate much appeal. Certain studies, however, suggest that young voters partly influenced the verdicts in the 2014 and 2019 general elections.

In the 75-year electoral history of India, while votes have been garnered under labels such as community, caste, class, farmers, industrial workers and even government employees, there has been no block identification of the youth as yet. There are steady references to the votes of Dalits, minorities, Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes and Other Backward Classes, as well as the Yadav vote in Uttar Pradesh and the so-called M-Y vote in Bihar – patterns that have held steady over decades.

To these has now been added, in good measure, the women’s vote. A house for shelter, a toilet on the premises, gas in the kitchen and electricity at home can capture the imagination of women across regions, besides cash delivered directly into their wallets. Gratitude is then expressed through the ballot.

For reasons yet to be overcome, caste and community continue to abide as assured aggregators in the electoral arena. These, along with gender identity, have considerably subsumed youth identity. Critical issues such as

For newborns, the answer is hospital plus home

In India, newborns are dying. Earlier, they used to die at home without medical care. Now, they are dying in hospitals. On August 24, 2026, three newborns lost their lives in an accidental fire at the government women’s hospital in Amravati, Maharashtra. This was not the first such episode in government newborn care units, and it will not be the last – unless we view it not as an isolated event, but as a trend.

These are episodes of clustered newborn deaths in the government institutions (that were identified by ChatGPT)/in the format of Year/Government hospital/Newborn deaths – 2017 BRD Medical College, Gorakhpur 17; 2017 Government hospital, Ahmedabad 18; 2019 JK Lon Hospital, Kota 10; 2020 JK Lon Hospital, Kota 9; 2020 Government hospital, Shahdol 8; 2021 District Hospital, Bhandara One fire 10; 2021 Kamla Nehru Children’s Hospital, Bhopal One fire 4; 2021 Government Medical College, Ambikapur 4; 2022 Medical College, Ambikapur 4; 2023 Government Medical College, Nanded 12; 2024 Maharani Laxmi Bai Medical College, Jhansi One fire 10; 2025 District Women’s Hospital, Budaun 4; 2026 District Women’s Hospital, Amravati One fire 3

This is not a comprehensive national registry, but only a partial list. The pattern, however, is recurring and therefore demands a systemic response.

The problems and challenges

What is going wrong? The first reason is overcrowding. India has achieved remarkable success in ensuring that women increasingly deliver in health institutions – from 39% in 2005-06 to 90% in 2023-24 (National Family Health Survey-6). But this success has created a new challenge. The absolute number of women delivering in institutions has risen from 109 lakh in 2005 to 194 lakh in 2024-25 (Ministry of Health and Family Welfare (MoHFW), Government of India). The total number of sick newborns hospitalised in public Special Newborn Care Units (SNCUs) has also risen rapidly, from 11.3 lakh in 2021-22 to 14.45 lakh in 2023-24 – a 28% increase in two years (Health Management Information System, MoHFW). Hence, newborn-care units everywhere are becoming overloaded.



Abhay Bang

Physician and the founder of Society for Education, Action and Research in Community Health (SEARCH), a community health research organisation

Newborn care in India must combine safer, decongested neonatal units with strengthened home-based support

The second reason is the changing case mix. As institutional deliveries have expanded, government hospitals have become the destination not only for normal deliveries but also for large numbers of high-risk births, including premature, low-birth-weight and sick newborns referred from peripheral facilities.

Infrastructure failures are the third reason. The Gorakhpur episode of August 2017 was attributed by a district-level inquiry to oxygen deprivation following an interruption in oxygen supply. The fires at Bhandara in January 2021, Bhopal in November 2021 and Jhansi in November 2024, as well as the more recent incident in Amravati, demonstrate the risks posed by fire and electrical hazards in neonatal units. Sick newborns need warmers, incubators and ventilators. Overcrowding can increase the electrical load on these units.

Infection and staffing problems would be the fourth reason. Overcrowding, inadequate nurse-to-baby ratios, equipment shortages and poor infection-prevention practices can turn a neonatal unit into a setting where hospital-acquired infections can spread rapidly.

The Gadchiroli model

This diagnosis leads to some obvious solutions. But there is an additional way.

India already has another solution. More than two decades ago, the Gadchiroli field trial conducted by the Society for Education, Action and Research in Community Health (SEARCH) demonstrated that trained community health workers (CHWs) could provide effective home-based neonatal care (HBNC), resulting in a 62.2% reduction in neonatal mortality in the rural area (The Lancet, 1999). The trained CHWs identified and managed neonatal infections at home, supported breastfeeding and warmth, and managed low-birth-weight and preterm babies. Subsequent data from Gadchiroli, published in the Journal of Perinatology in 2005, showed that between 1996 and 2003, 97% of low-birth-weight and preterm babies – including those with birth weights above 1,800 g and gestational ages of more than 34 weeks – were managed at home, with a very low case-fatality rate.

The principles of the Gadchiroli model have

employment and education constitute only a loose overhang.

Youth participation in India’s elections has remained low-key compared with other demographic categories, despite an improvement in recent years, and largely due to the mobilisation efforts of the Election Commission of India (ECI). The ECI has recently galvanised its electoral literacy campaigns to orient students in schools and colleges to the electoral system, processes and practices, and to secure their informed participation.

The upcoming Assembly elections in Uttarakhand, Uttar Pradesh, Punjab, Manipur and Goa will be the earliest test case to determine whether the noisy voice of the streets gets organised into a political preference, including the amount of youth candidature. A quarter of the Assembly seats in these States, especially in politically muscular Uttar Pradesh, were won roughly by margins of around 5% and could, hence, easily be swung by Gen Z voters. The comparison ends there. The youth of Uttar Pradesh and Punjab do not share a common predicament; neither do the Gen Z in Goa and Manipur, or, for that matter, the youth of Gujarat and Himachal Pradesh, which go to the polls later in 2027. Electorally speaking, the current political attention on the youth can be interpreted as an attempt to cut possible losses while making a moderate investment.

Old equations do matter

Political parties cannot abandon time-tested voting blocs for an undependable, heterogeneous multitude that may or may not walk out of its Instagram residency. Old social calculations and booth management may still hold good in actual polls, while the youth awakening may remain a story on the side. Political parties and poll campaigners have a professional finger on the pulse of the people; they will carefully watch the emergence of a real Gen Z vote from the cradle, while they adjust their plans and campaigns just that bit for now.

In the text of the Union government’s vision of a developed India by 2047, the youth are regarded as the *Amrit Peedhi* (the generation of the nectar). But in realpolitik, the forthcoming State elections may show which side the nectar sweetens or whether it does so at all. Swami Vivekananda spoke of the power of youth, but in an electoral sense, that power may only now be crystallising in India.

The views expressed are personal

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

The first step

The alleged theft of devotees’ donations, amounting to hundreds of crores, has seriously eroded the credibility of the Ayodhya Ram Temple administration and the Yogi Adityanath government in Uttar Pradesh. The U.P. government apparently had no inkling of what was going on. The move to

appoint a retired Air Marshal as the CEO of the Ram Temple Trust (Inside pages, September 3) and other carefully selected trustees is a step towards injecting professionalism into the administration. It is incumbent upon the U.P. Government to keep a hawk’s eye on the temple administration and conduct periodic checks to ensure

that everything is functioning smoothly. **C.V. Aravind**, Bengaluru

Building castles in the air

One really wonders why the Congress party and the Tamilaga Vetttri Kazhagam (TVK) in Tamil Nadu are thinking aloud about who should be the next Prime Minister of India — Rahul

Gandhi, Congress leader and Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha, or C. Joseph Vijay, TVK president and Tamil

Nadu Chief Minister. Mr. Vijay has completed only 100-odd days as Chief Minister. Rather, he is still an

Corrections & Clarifications

A report, “Air Force veteran appointed first Ram Temple Trust CEO” (Inside pages, September 3, 2026), incorrectly referred to Air Marshal Jeetendra Mishra (retired) as *Air Vice-Marshal Jitendra Mishra* (retd.) in both the text and the caption of the photograph.

The Readers’ Editor’s office can be contacted by Telephone: +91-44-28576300; E-mail: readerseditor@thehindu.co.in

apprentice on the job and should focus on becoming a successful Chief Minister. Moreover, Prime Minister Narendra Modi is still on a strong wicket and, at this point in time, appears irreplaceable.

S. Ramakrishnasayee, Chennai

Letters emailed to letters@thehindu.co.in must carry the postal address.

Text & Context

THE HINDU

NEWS IN NUMBERS

Number of villages inundated by floods in north Odisha

373 The flood situation in north Odisha remained grim on Thursday, with 373 villages inundated across Balasore, Jajpur and Mayurbhanj districts, officials said. The Subarnarekha inundated 214 villages in Balasore, while 62 villages in Jajpur and 97 villages in Mayurbhanj were affected. Around 35,740 people from Balasore were evacuated. PTI

Number of industrial units for which IDCO cleared land in Odisha

37 The Odisha Industrial Infrastructure Development Corporation has allotted land to 37 industrial units, including 24 major projects and 13 proposals aimed at promoting micro, small and medium enterprises, officials said on Thursday. The IDCO Land Allotment Committee approved the proposals at a meeting held on Wednesday, a statement said. PTI

Number of jobs provided by Himachal govt. in three years

1.6 in lakh. The Congress and the BJP sparred in the Himachal Pradesh Assembly on Thursday, with the Opposition staging a walkout. Parliamentary Affairs and Industries Minister Harshwardhan Chauhan claimed in the House that the government has provided 1,60,729 employment opportunities, including 32,223 government jobs. PTI

Internally Displaced Persons living in relief camps across Manipur

24 in thousands. Manipur Chief Minister Yumnam Khemchand Singh on Thursday informed the Assembly that 36,000 out of around 60,000 internally displaced persons (IDPs) have been resettled. Replying to a discussion moved by Congress MLA Th. Lokeshwar Singh, the Chief Minister said that around 24,000 IDPs were still living in relief camps across the State. PTI

Excess deaths during heatwaves in Belgium between June-August

2935 Belgium recorded 2,935 excess deaths during successive heatwaves between June and August 2026, according to the Sciensano national public health institute. Of these, 2,035 extra deaths were recorded between June 18 and July 3, while another 535 occurred between July 4 and 17. AFP

COMPILED BY THE HINDU DATA TEAM

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The gap in manufacturing sector GVA

According to the National Accounts Statistics, the manufacturing sector's GVA is ₹38.6 lakh crore in 2023-24 at current prices; however, an 'Alternative Estimate' using data from the Annual Survey of Industries and Annual Survey of Unincorporated Sector Enterprises gives a lower figure, prompting a closer look at the official estimate

ECONOMIC NOTES

Jatinder S. Bedi
R. Nagaraj

Early this year, the National Statistical Office (NSO) released the new series of the National Accounts Statistics (NAS). It shows that the manufacturing sector's gross value added (GVA) is ₹38.6 lakh crore (₹38.6 trillion), constituting 14.7 per cent of GDP (gross domestic product) for the year 2023-24 at current prices. How reliable is the official estimate? This article investigates.

The manufacturing sector has two parts: One comprises all registered factories employing 10+/20+ workers with/without power, including registered companies (defined as the organised/formal sector). The other comprises unincorporated/ informal/ household units consisting of small factories/workshops falling outside the corporate/factory sector. The Annual Survey of Industries (ASI) reports the production accounts of the factory sector, while the Annual Survey of Unincorporated Sector Enterprises (ASUSE) covers the informal sector. The combined output (GVA) of the factory and unincorporated sectors almost completely represents total manufacturing output.

The discrepancy in estimates

For 2023-24, the sum of the GVA of units covered by the ASI and ASUSE is ₹27.4 lakh crore (the Alternative Estimate or, AE). The official figure, as per the NAS, is ₹38.6 lakh crore. It is higher than the AE by a whopping 40.9 per cent. Let's call this the GAP. What could account for it?

While minor variations between the two estimates is understandable due to methodological or definitional issues, such a substantial GAP between the two estimates using official data sources surely raises many questions.

What are the data sources used for estimating the official GVA? For the unincorporated sector, it is ASUSE - the same as what we have used to estimate the AE. Hence, it cannot account for the GAP noted above. Moreover, the unincorporated sector's share in total manufacturing GVA is a mere 13.9 per cent.

Hence, the reason for the GAP must lie in the estimation of organised manufacturing output. The NAS uses company balance-sheet data sourced from the Ministry of Corporate Affairs' database (MCA-21), compiled using the annual statutory filings by registered companies. This practice of using the MCA data began with the previous NAS revision (base year 2011-12), partially replacing the ASI. The procedure has continued in the latest revision, with minor modifications.

A standard way to validate the GVA is to use employment data to estimate the sector's potential output by applying appropriate "technical ratios" drawn from the ASI and ASUSE datasets. The official Periodic Labour Force Survey (PLFS) for 2023-24, estimated that the manufacturing sector employed 697.5 lakh workers.

However, as per the ASI and ASUSE datasets, only 532.9 lakh workers were employed to produce the official GVA. Thus, quite possibly, the contribution of the remaining 164.6 lakh "residual workers" - 697.5 minus 532.9 - may account for the GAP in the GVA reported above.



The manufacturing sector includes the organised sector comprising registered factories and companies, and the unincorporated sector comprising small factories and workshops outside the corporate sector. REPRESENTATIVE IMAGE

THE GIST

The National Accounts Statistics data shows that the manufacturing sector's GVA is ₹38.6 lakh crore for 2023-24, constituting 14.7 per cent of GDP. However, as per an Alternative Estimate, the sum of the GVA of units covered by the ASI and ASUSE is ₹27.4 lakh crore, a 40.9 per cent difference

The potential GVA of 'residual workers', not captured by ASI and ASUSE data, is estimated to be ₹3.6 lakh crore. Adding this to the AE of ₹27.4 lakh crore, the potential overall manufacturing GVA could be ₹31.0 lakh crore

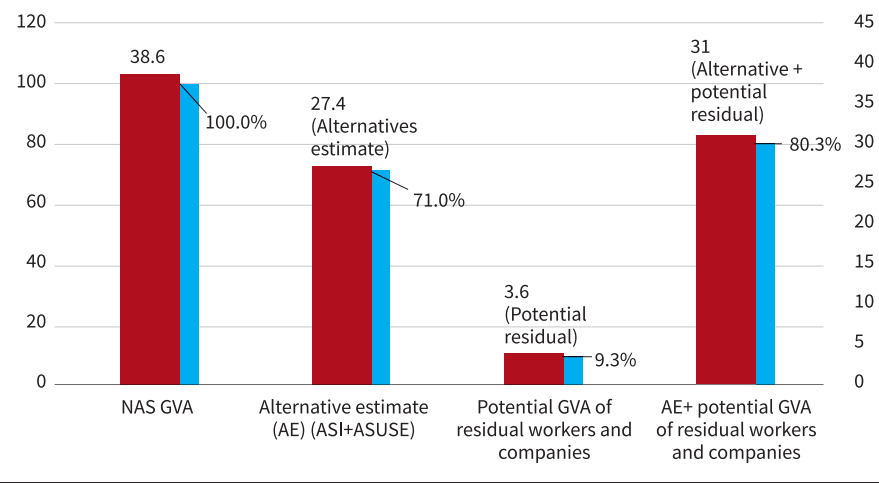
Whether the official estimate represents a 'fuller description of ground reality' through use of corporate data, or amounts to an overestimation of output, is a matter of contention. The statistical issue can only be resolved if the NSO's methodologies are made public

Conflicting figures

An alternative estimate of manufacturing sector GVA using time-tested official datasets puts the figure below the official estimate

Figure 1: Official manufacturing sector GVA and Alternative Estimates for 2023-24

■ Per cent ■ ₹ Lakh crore



The definitions of employment in the three surveys are not the same, and their data collection methods differ. However, for a validation exercise, the PLFS estimates provide a useful reference point. Official agencies also use similar methods.

Some of this GAP is contributed by the residual 2,72,534 MCA companies, not covered in the 78,618 "private companies" captured in the ASI data. A majority of the residual companies are likely to be non-factory private companies. The left over residual workers are likely to belong to the unincorporated sector not covered in ASUSE survey because of their small size.

Then, applying the "technical ratios" of the appropriate segments of manufacturing as derived from unit-wise

ASI and ASUSE data, the potential GVA of the residual workers is estimated to be ₹3.6 lakh crore.

Then adding the potential GVA to the AE of ₹27.4 lakh crore reported earlier, the likely/potential overall manufacturing GVA could be ₹31.0 lakh crore.

This figure, however, still falls short of the official GVA estimate (of ₹38.6 lakh crore) by 24.5 per cent. In other words, the potential GVA of all workers employed in the manufacturing sector in companies and unincorporated sector enterprises would at best account for 80.3 per cent of the official estimate. It still leaves ₹7.6 lakh crore (or 19.7%) worth of NAS manufacturing GVA "unaccounted" for or "unexplained" (Figure 1). This is the real puzzle of the new GDP figures for the manufacturing sector.

How can this GAP be reconciled with the best alternative estimate obtained using widely used data sources? The NSO documents say that, being an establishment-based survey, the ASI reportedly fails to capture value addition taking place within an enterprise, but outside of the factory premises (such as head office, marketing and distribution, or R&D activities). Is this really true? Probably not. Available evidence does not seem to support the official view (Dholakia, Nagaraj and Pandya, *Economic and Political Weekly*, 2018).

Alternatively, if the ASI-based GVA estimate did not underestimate production, how could such a large GAP arise. Is it because of the NSO methodology of scaling up of sample estimates of active companies for the universe of companies whose size and composition are hazy and unverified?

The statistical issue

As per the latest NAS, for 2023-24, manufacturing GVA is ₹38.6 lakh crore at current prices. An alternative estimate, using time-tested official ASI and ASUSE data sets, finds the official figure to be higher than the alternative estimate by 40.9 per cent.

Even after accounting for the contribution of residual companies and workers, the unexplained GAP remains at 24.5 per cent. Whether the official estimate represents a "fuller description of ground reality" through the use of corporate data, or amounts to an overestimation of output, remains a matter of contention. The statistical issue can only be resolved if the MCA data and NSO's methodologies are made public for independent verification.

(Jatinder S. Bedi is a Professor of Economics at the Institute for Development and Communication, Chandigarh. R. Nagaraj was formerly with the Indira Gandhi Institute of Development Research (IGIDR), Mumbai)

IN THE LIMELIGHT



A filmmaking legend:Singeetham understands that not everything needs to be said through dialogue, a skill he has excelled in since his early days as a writer. FILE PHOTO

Inside the mind of Singeetham Srinivasa Rao: a masterclass in storytelling

Veteran filmmaker and an instinctive writer, Rao has spent several years exploring the possibilities of storytelling — across languages, genres and forms. At 95, he remains as curious about cinema as he has always been

Sudhish Kamath

Kamal Haasan once told me that every storyteller has one story and they just find different ways to say it. “One man in another man’s shoes,” he winked, talking about his oldest living collaborator Singeetham Srinivasa Rao.

Seemed like the perfect icebreaker for an interview with the 95-year-old legendary storyteller.

For a lot of his films begin by disturbing someone’s identity or place in the world — Shekhar and Ranga in *Sommokadidhi Sokokadidhi*, Kamal in *Pushpak*, *Apoorva Sagodharargal* and *Michael Madana Kama Rajan*. Does putting a character in a situation where they don’t belong, inspire the story, I ask the legend over a Zoom call on a Wednesday morning.

The starting point

“Yes, though there are a lot of these common elements, the starting point is always an idea. Let me give you some examples: *Sing Geetham* was an idea that I got many years ago from a conversation with Balamurali Krishna when he said there’s music in everyday life. And I wanted to explore how to capture that music from life.”

He demonstrates with an example from *Sing Geetham* where a random line spoken blends two notes. *Pushpak*, he says, was born out of a desire to pay tribute to the era of silent films and Chaplin.

And *Aditya 369* was a film that was inspired not just by H.G. Wells and the *Back to the Future* films but by Mark Twain’s *A Connecticut Yankee in King Arthur’s Court*.

Twain’s book, one of his early influences, might offer a clue on where Rao got hooked to the concept of one man in another man’s world.

Entering the cave

There were simply no screenwriting books or textbooks when he started filmmaking. One of the first lessons his mentor K.V. Reddy gave him was that every detail on paper is sacred.

“If you write cave, the production and camera departments will not know automatically that it has to be dark. You have to write dark cave.” And that’s how Rao learnt on set, as young writers figure out, the significance of the scene header INT./EXT. LOCATION - DAY/NIGHT.

Rao is a writer with instinct — when he starts to write a story, he never tries to guess if it is working or not. “You have to go with your conviction. Nobody will know whether it’s working or not until people watch it and tell you,” he laughs. So, it is a bit of shooting in the dark, sticking to the conviction, which is why it helps that he is always thinking of the little details to flesh out the scene.

Music and spark in the detail

I prod him on *Pushpak* — the way the audio of the Finance Minister’s speech on radio on the need to respect retired officers, is in sharp contrast to the behaviour of an old man checking out a maid, or even that scene with scatological humour without resorting to the sounds of toilet humour. “Yes, contrast is always the best way to find comedy in the scene. What if the place where he got the drunk man tied up is next door to a dance school?” And that’s how the sound of the classical dance instructor in the background provides the score for a scene that could have potentially grossed out audiences. But with the contrast, they laugh with him instead.

As an instinctive writer, Rao understands that not everything needs to be said through dialogue, a skill he has excelled in since his early days as a writer, from *Sommokadidhi Sokokadidhi*, where we get a peek into conman Ranga’s mind

when he watches Shekhar at work. There are a lot of Chaplinesque silent movie devices he employs in it that he carried forward to *Pushpak*, where one suspects his love for finding the music in life led him to think of two ideas — the silent film and the musical film where everyone sings out their lines.

It took decades before he could get from the first to the second, but he continued using musical narration to achieve great economy in storytelling.

You might remember the narrator singing the fable of *Michael Madana Kama Rajan*. By the time the opening credits end, we know how they were separated at birth.

Resolving conflict through laughs

How does Rao negotiate writer-star conflicts during the writing process, I wonder, especially since he has collaborated most with Kamal Haasan, who is often credited on screenplays of his films. “There’s no negotiation. Only collaboration. Because without a star, there’s no film,” he laughs.

How did he learn the art of comedy? Larry David, for example, found his voice by subverting social interactions. Garry Shandling struggled with self-doubt and decided that if he is funny in real life, he doesn’t have to learn to be funny on stage.

Rao says he does not know about any of that theory. “I think I have always had a sense of humour. That’s probably the secret of my health. I am hale and hearty because I laugh a lot.”

He narrates a story from many decades ago, when he and his friend Ananthu had to travel by train from Madras to Bombay, pretending to be siblings to match with the identities on the ticket. So, they wore dark glasses, pretending to have conjunctivitis. “But throughout the journey, I could not stop laughing. I could not keep a straight face.”

That anecdote does offer an insight into how Rao discovered the comedy of the average Joe in an otherworldly situation.

Finally, I ask him for a writing exercise that might help young filmmakers discover their own voice. “Take any proverb you like. Any old saying. And turn it into a modern story,” he suggests.

Traditional wisdom and universal truths explored through an everyday lens might just help a young writer or two discover who they are as writers.

Also, Rao has never stopped watching films. From the days he and Balu Mahendra went film-hopping at international film festivals, to discussing *Pather Panchali* with Satyajit Ray and deconstructing Manmohan Desai’s lost-and-found tropes.

“In one scene, three guys are giving blood to each other. People just didn’t care that it’s not realistic,” he recalls of that iconic scene from *Amar Akbar Anthony*.

Even recently, he reached out to this writer after watching his film *Culture Vulture* on YouTube and sought to reach out to Ravish Kumar to share his words of appreciation for ‘While You Were Watching’.

It was a year ago when this writer had approached Rao for an interview on his writing process. Between then and now Rao has already had a highly acclaimed release in *Sing Geetham*, serves as a story consultant on *Kalki 2898 AD* and is sharp enough to get working on the next — a historical spy thriller currently in the early stages of writing — yet another twist to one man’s adventure in another man’s world?

At 95, the incredible true story of a young man who couldn’t stop laughing, finding himself in many adventures with Kamal Haasan, is far from over. He is still finding new worlds to put his men into — and new ways to make us laugh.



FROM THE ARCHIVES

Know your English

S. Upendran

What is the meaning of “bolt from the blue”? (R. Ranjith Kumar, Eraiyyur)

This is an expression, which has been a part of the English language for a very long time. When you say that something was a “bolt from the blue” or a “bolt out of the blue”, it means that it was sudden and totally unexpected; whatever happened really surprised you. Here are a few examples.

The news that Sumithra had lung cancer was a bolt from the blue.

Gauri seemed to really like her new job. So when she informed her parents last week that she was planning on quitting, it was a bolt out of the blue.

The word “blue” in the expression refers to the blue sky and “bolt” refers to thunderbolts. On a day when the sky is blue and there are no clouds around, one does not expect to hear thunder. If one does, one is really surprised.

What is the meaning of the term “vox populi”? (G. K. Karthigakumaran, Chennai)

This is an expression borrowed from Latin meaning “voice of the people”. The term is often abbreviated to either “vox pop” or “vox pops”.

The vox pop technique is normally used in radio and television broadcasting. We often see reporters walking around on the streets asking passers by to give their opinion about something. For example, we have people responding to questions as to whether America did the right thing by bombing Afghanistan.

This method of recording the opinions of people talking informally in public places is called vox populi or vox pop.

Sai Prasad is a director who likes to make use of vox pop in his programmes.

Can you get me some vox populi by six this evening?

What is the difference between “plenty” and “aplenty”? (S.S. Prasanna Venkatesh, Chennai)

As far as the meaning is concerned there is hardly any difference between the two. Both mean “large amounts of”. Of the two “aplenty” is considered old fashioned. Here are a few examples.

Plenty of children joined the competition.

We have plenty of sugar left. When you use the word “aplenty”, it usually comes after the noun. For example,

Children aplenty joined the competition.

We have sugar aplenty. I have read thrillers aplenty.

It would be wrong to say “aplenty children”, “aplenty thrillers”, etc.

How does one refer to one’s country? “fatherland” or “motherland”? (T. Desai, Mumbai)

How you refer to your country depends upon what your mother tongue happens to be. In most Indian languages, we generally use the feminine gender to refer to our country. Native speakers of English invariably refer to their country as their “motherland”. But the Germans, on the other hand, refer to Germany as their “fatherland”. So, both “motherland” and “fatherland” are acceptable ways of referring to one’s country. Published in *The Hindu* on November 13, 2001

THE DAILY QUIZ

Gloria Steinem passed away yesterday at the age of 92. Here is a quiz on the eminent American feminist and journalist

Radhika Santhanam

QUESTION 1
What was the name of the feminist magazine she co-founded in 1971 which survives till today?

QUESTION 2
Steinem said once that she had never wanted children because she already had one. Who was she referring to?

QUESTION 3
Steinem was part of the second wave of feminism. Name the book credited with launching this wave, written by Betty Friedan.

QUESTION 4
In 2005, Steinem, Robin Morgan, and X co-founded an organisation that “works to make women visible and powerful in the media”. Name X, an actor who starred in *Klute* and *Coming Home*.

QUESTION 5
In a controversial op-ed, Steinem once defended a U.S. President saying his behaviour with women may have been reckless, but did not meet the legal definition of sexual harassment or assault. Which President was she talking about?



Visual question: Where did she work, which led to her seminal 1963 undercover exposé, ‘A Bunny’s Tale’?

Questions and answers to the previous day’s daily quiz: 1. The year and place where Lionel Messi won the Olympic Gold and the Under-20 World Cup. **Ans: 2008 at Beijing and 2005 in the Netherlands**
2. Goals and assists by Messi in his 207-match career for ‘La Albiceleste’ **Ans: 125 goals, with 111 with his left foot, and 68 assists**
3. Messi had a senior international debut to forget on August 17, 2005, because he was shown a straight red card, less than a minute after coming on in the 63rd minute, for an accidental elbow to an opponent, against this European team. **Ans: Hungary**
4. The final heartbreak which prompted Messi’s first international retirement in June 2016. **Ans: The Copa America defeat to Chile**
5. Messi holds the record for most major tournament goals in men’s history with ____ goals. **Ans: 35**
6. Messi share the record for FIFA World Cup appearances (six in total) with this football player. **Ans: Cristiano Ronaldo**
7. He has netted the most international goals (11) against this South American country. **Ans: Bolivia**
Visual: Messi is celebrating the triumph in this tournament. **Ans: The Finalissima against Italy in 2022**
Early birds: Arun Kumar Singh | Sudhir Thapa | Tito Shiladitya | Piyali Tuli | Samir Gupta



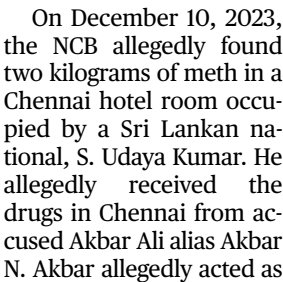
Please send in your answers to
dailyquiz@thehindu.co.in



For feedback and suggestions for Text & Context, please write to **letters@thehindu.co.in** with the subject ‘Text & Context’

The Bench said the August 13 letters of the BCI were “obsolete”.

The records *prima facie* revealed an arrangement in which different persons handled procurement and financing of meth, its transportation, and onward de-



The Karnataka case is linked to Mruthyunjaya

The second Kerala case pertains to accused Linges, who was intercepted on arrival from Muscat after 949.26 gm of MDMA, worth around ₹50 lakh, was found on him. The ED searched four locations in Kozhikode.

The submission was made in a *suo motu* proceeding initiated in 2025 after the court took note of a media report highlighting non-functional CCTV cameras at police stations in Udaipur. The court had subsequently sought compliance reports from the Centre, States, and Union Territories while reviewing the implementation of its 2021 judgment in *Paramvir Singh Saini vs Baljit Singh* case, which mandated the installation of CCTV cameras at key locations in stations, including lock-ups and the rooms of inspectors and sub-inspectors.

India and Belgium ramp up bilateral defence cooperation

After meeting his Belgian counterpart, Prime Minister calls for ending conflicts in Ukraine and West Asia through dialogue; three government-level defence agreements signed; two sides also announce the establishment of a fast trade mechanism

Kallol Bhattacharjee
NEW DELHI

Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Thursday called for dialogue and diplomacy to end the ongoing conflicts in Ukraine and West Asia.

Mr. Modi made the remarks while welcoming Belgian Prime Minister Bart De Wever here, where the two sides ramped up bilateral defence cooperation by signing three government-level defence agreements.

Belgian sources informed that at least 10 private defence agreements will be sealed during the visit that will include production of Belgian military items such as rockets in India.

“Whether it is Ukraine or West Asia, we support all efforts aimed at an early end to conflicts and the restoration of peace. And



Boosting ties: Prime Minister Narendra Modi with Prime Minister of Belgium Bart De Wever in New Delhi. SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA

eliminating terrorism in all its forms and manifestations is our shared commitment,” Mr. Modi said in his remarks after he and Mr. De Wever discussed global and regional issues.

Paid tributes

The two leaders also paid tributes to the more than 9,000 Indian soldiers who perished in the Flanders

Fields during the First World War. A Joint Statement issued at the end of the discussions announced that the two leaders called for “safety and security of maritime routes and maintaining safe and unimpeded maritime shipping” in the context of the conflicts in West Asia and Ukraine.

The Belgian dignitary expressed support to In-

dia’s campaign against cross-border terrorism and condemned the Pahalgam terror attack.

In his remarks at an event organised by the CII (Confederation of Indian Industry), the Belgian leader described the current global situation as “turbulent” and called for free trade and end to unilateral imposition of tariffs.

The two governments signed a Letter of Intent of Defence Cooperation, an MoU between Belgian Security and Defence Industry and Society of Indian Defence Manufacturers, and an MoU between the Central Bureau of Investigation and Belgium Federal Police on cooperation in combating transnational organised crime, cyber-crime and related matters.

“Our security does not stop at our borders. That is why we need to work more closely with strong part-

ners such as India – militarily, technologically and industrially,” said Belgian Defence Minister Theo Francken.

On this occasion, India announced that a Defence Attache will be appointed at the Indian Embassy in Brussels. The visit included defence partnerships between Belgian and Indian defence majors. “Today, India and Europe are speaking the language of trade with renewed conviction, a language of peace, of progress and of prosperity,” said Mr. De Wever.

The two sides announced the establishment of a fast trade mechanism that will deal with trade and investment and announced that bilateral trade will be doubled in the next five years. They also announced the establishment of Consular Dialogue between New Delhi and Brussels.

No defence ties with Pak., Belgium assures India

Saurabh Trivedi
NEW DELHI

Belgium has assured India that it will not pursue defence cooperation or provide technological assistance to Pakistan, sources in the government said on Thursday, following bilateral talks between Defence Minister Rajnath Singh and Belgium’s Defence Minister Theo Francken.

According to the sources, during the meeting in New Delhi, Mr. Singh specifically raised India’s concerns over the possibility of Belgian defence technology or expertise being extended to Pakistan. Mr. Francken assured the Indian side that Belgium stood firmly with India and that there was “no question” of defence cooperation with Pakistan.

The assurance assumes significance as India has been raising concerns with its international partners over the transfer of defence technologies and military equipment that could strengthen Pakis-



Union Minister Rajnath Singh holding a bilateral meeting with his Belgium counterpart Theo Francken in New Delhi on Thursday. ANI

tan’s military capabilities.

During the interaction, the two sides reviewed the entire spectrum of bilateral defence and industrial cooperation. The Ministers agreed to expand engagement through defence cooperation dialogue, high-level visits, training and capacity building.

They also discussed regional peace and security and acknowledged the need for greater maritime security collaboration in the Indo-Pacific. Both sides reiterated that the India-Belgium partnership is based on shared values, mutual trust and respect.

The bilateral meeting was held on the sidelines of talks between Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Belgian Prime Minister Bart De Wever, who is on an official visit to India.

Earlier, Mr. Francken and Minister of State for Defence Sanjay Seth addressed the India-Belgium Defence CEOs Roundtable and B2B Meetings here.

Emphasising the potential for deeper industrial collaboration, the Belgian Defence Minister called for joint efforts to strengthen the armed forces of both countries in an evolving security environment.

Kharge writes to Nadda, questions delay in action in ‘purification’ row

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge on Thursday said the *shuddhikaran* (purification) of the Ramli ground in Haldwani area of Uttarakhand, where he had addressed a political rally, amounted to practising “untouchability”, and said his party would approach Rajya Sabha Chairman C.P. Radhakrishnan over the issue.

On September 2, Mr. Kharge, who is the Leader of the Opposition in the Rajya Sabha, wrote to Union Minister and Leader of the

Rajya Sabha J.P. Nadda, urging him to direct Uttarakhand Chief Minister Pushkar Singh Dhami to ensure that an FIR was registered against those responsible for the alleged purification ritual.

Cites Nadda’s assurance

In his letter, which was released on Thursday, Mr. Kharge recalled that he had raised the matter in the Rajya Sabha on August 13 and that Mr. Nadda had assured the House that the incident would be investigated and strict action taken against those found guilty. “Even after 24 days

of this incident, not even an FIR has been filed against the organisations and individuals involved in this heinous act,” he said.

He linked the incident to the history of caste discrimination, recalling that during the Mahad Satyagraha, when B.R. Ambedkar drank water from a public tank, caste Hindus had subsequently performed a purification ritual using *gomutra* and *gobar*.

“This issue transcends my personal self or the office of the Indian National Congress president; it is deeply connected to the sentiments of crores of pe-

ople who confront this harsh reality on a daily basis,” he said in his letter.

The Congress president said the ritual at the Ramli Maidan, following his August 8 rally, was contrary to the spirit of the Constitution and human values. “This is an incident of untouchability, it is not just about purification,” he told presspersons here.

Mr. Kharge also questioned the silence of Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Union Home Minister Amit Shah on the issue. “Whenever something wrong happens, they remain silent,” he said.

Congress questions GDP revisions, asks Centre to explain methodology

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Congress on Thursday posed four questions to the government over the latest GDP estimates, seeking an explanation for a cumulative downward revision of ₹43 lakh crore in the estimated size of the Indian economy over the past four years and questioning the methodology used to calculate real growth.

In a statement, Congress leader Jairam Ramesh asked why GDP estimates for all four years since 2022-23 had been revised substantially down-



Jairam Ramesh

wards, what components of the new methodology had driven the changes, who had been consulted in framing it and why the deflator used for calculating real GDP appeared to understate the impact of inflation. “How has a change

in methodology produced such a large drop in the estimated size of the Indian economy,” he asked.

The questions came days after the government highlighted 7.8% real GDP growth in the April-June 2026 quarter. Mr. Ramesh said the figure required closer scrutiny and alleged that the revisions had made the growth rate appear stronger than it was.

Garg’s analysis

He pointed to repeated revisions to the GDP estimate for April-June 2025, which had brought the figure down from about ₹86 lakh

crore to ₹80 lakh crore. Citing calculations by former Finance Secretary Subhash Chandra Garg, Mr. Ramesh said nominal growth in the latest quarter would have been closer to 2.6%, instead of the reported 10.3%, had the earlier base not been revised downwards.

Mr. Ramesh cited concerns raised by former Chief Economic Adviser Arvind Subramanian and the IMF over India’s national accounts, arguing that the Centre needed to provide greater transparency on the methodology underlying the estimates.

Cong. insulted Ram Temple, Army, says BJP leader

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Bharatiya Janata Party on Thursday accused the Congress of having an “anti-Army” and “anti-Shri Ram Temple” mindset, citing the questions raised by Congress leader and former MP Rashid Alvi on the appointment of Air Marshal Jeetendra Mishra (retd) as the first CEO of the Shri Ram Janmabhoomi Teerth Kshetra Trust.

At a press briefing, BJP MP Sudhanshu Trivedi said Mr. Alvi’s statement reflected the Congress’s attitude of “insulting the Indian Army and the Shri Ram Temple” and described it as evidence of the “*dimagi* Naxal” mindset.

Targeting the Congress, he said its leaders demanded proof of the surgical strike, the Balakot strike, and called India’s Army chief a “*sadakhchap gunda*” (street thug). “These are the same people whose leader Navjot Singh Sidhu went and hugged Pakistan’s Army chief Qamar Bajwa,” he said.

Even after the statements by Pakistan’s Prime Minister and President about ‘Operation Sindoor’, if the Congress still had doubts, anyone harbouring such doubts could only be a “*dimagi* Naxal”, he alleged.

Cong. leaders discuss issues in Punjab unit

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The top leadership of the Congress, including the Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi and party general secretary (organisation) K.C. Venugopal, is said to have discussed the leadership tussle within the party in Punjab at a meeting at party president Mallikarjun Kharge’s official residence.

In a separate meeting, the top leaders also met Himachal Pradesh Chief Minister Sukhvinder Singh Sukhu and the Pradesh Congress Committee chief to discuss a possible Cabinet reshuffle in the State.

There was no official

word on the details of the meeting on Punjab, but it comes ahead of a proposed political yatra by Mr. Gandhi in the State, where elections are scheduled to be held early next year.

The dates for the yatra are likely to be finalised once the Congress resolves the intense factionalism in the Punjab unit.

Upset at not being made the PCC chief or the Chief Ministerial face before the Punjab polls, former Chief Minister Charanjit Singh Channi and his supporters had expressed displeasure that the Scheduled Castes do not get adequate representation. The party is likely to urge him to spearhead the poll campaign in the State, sources indicated.

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Sl. No	Online Tender no with qty./ Document Cost	Sale Period	Pre bid	Submis-sion	Opening
1.	E1575/PACS/NHM/RC/TNMSC/ENG G/2026, dt: 03.09.2026 - Centralized PACS - Rs.5,725/-	07.09.2026 to 21.09.2026	15.09.2026 11.00 AM	22.09.2026 11.00 AM	22.09.2026 12.00 Noon
2.	E1576/MRB/RC/TNMSC/ENG/2026, dt: 03.09.2026 - Application and Registration System (OARS), Recruitment Process Management System (RPMS) and Pre-Examination Activities in the Regions for Recruitment of Medical and Allied Health Services for Govt. Medical Institutions through Medical Services Recruitment Board in Tamilnadu – Rs.5,725/-	08.09.2026 to 15.09.2026	11.09.2026 11.00 AM	16.09.2026 11.00 AM	16.09.2026 12.00 Noon

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Bid Identification No.Civil/EST-21/2026-27 : TCN No.25250, dt.25/08/2026

NOTICE INVITING TENDER UNDER NATIONAL COMPETITIVE BIDDING THROUGH e-Procurement

1. Name of the Work : Construction of Block level Stadium (without Indoor Hall), in Kodala Block under Ganjam District.

2. Value of the Work : Rs.11.38 Crore

3. Period of completion : 09 (Nine) Calendar Months

4. Availability of tender online for Bidding :

- Start Date : 18:00 Hours of dt.07.09.2026
- End Date : 15:00 Hours of dt.22.09.2026
- Opening date : 16:00 Hours of dt.22.09.2026.

Tender details can be seen from the e-procurement portal: www.tendersorissa.gov.in, Corrigendum or Addendum if any will not be published in newspapers and can be seen in e-procurement portal as well as in IDCO website.

Chief General Manager (Civil), IDCO, Bhubaneswar
4001/300/2627 **OIPR-4001/4075/1/26-27/0110**

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HIGHER EDUCATION DEPARTMENT

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PT1-HE-SCH-POLICY-0003-2026/47948/HE., Bhubaneswar, Dated:03.09.2026

Corrigendum-V

NOTICE INVITING RFP FOR PROCUREMENT, SUPPLY, INSTALLATION & COMMISSIONING OF LABORATORY EQUIPMENT & ITS ACCESSORIES FOR BERHAMPUR UNIVERSITY, GANJAM UNDER REGIONAL DIRECTORATE OF EDUCATION, BERHAMPUR APPROVED UNDER PM-USA.

RFP No. PM-USA-02/2026 Date: 02.07.2026

Sl. No.	RFP Cl.No.	Page No.	Description as per RFP	Modified vide Corrigendum IV, dated 19.08.2026	Now Modified Provisions
1	SHEET DATA (Sl.No.7 & 8)	5	Last Date & Time for Submission of Bid - 23/07/2026 till 4:00 PM (Registered Post & Speed Post only)	Last Date & Time for Submission of Bid - 08/09/2026 till 4:00 PM (Registered Post & Speed Post only)	Last Date & Time for Submission of Bid - 23/09/2026 till 4:00 PM (Registered Post & Speed Post only)
2		6	Date & Time of Opening of Technical Bid - 24/07/2026 at 4:00 PM	Last Date & Time for Submission of Bid - 09/09/2026 till 4:00 PM (Registered Post & Speed Post only)	Date & Time of Opening of Technical Bid - 29/09/2026 at 4:00 PM

All other terms and conditions of the RFP remain unchanged.

Joint Secretary to Govt. & SPD, PM-USA
11001/294/2627 **OIPR-11001/11001/1/26-27/0046**

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Bid Identification No.Civil/EST-24/2026-27 : TCN No.24754, dt.20/08/2026

NOTICE INVITING TENDER UNDER NATIONAL COMPETITIVE BIDDING THROUGH e-Procurement

1. Name of the Work : Construction of Block level Stadium (with Indoor Hall), in Kirimira Block under Jharsuguda District.

2. Value of the Work : Rs.1395.00 Lakhs

3. Period of completion : 12 (Twelve) Calendar Months

4. Availability of tender online for Bidding :

- Start Date : 18:00 Hours of dt.08.09.2026
- End Date : 17:00 Hours of dt.22.09.2026
- Opening date : 11:30 Hours of dt.23.09.2026.

Tender details can be seen from the e-procurement portal: www.tendersorissa.gov.in, Corrigendum or Addendum if any will not be published in newspapers and can be seen in e-procurement portal as well as in IDCO website.

Chief General Manager (Civil), IDCO, Bhubaneswar
4001/285/2627 **OIPR-4001/4075/1/26-27/0097**

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OFFICE OF THE CHIEF GENERAL MANAGER (CIVIL), IDCO, IDCO TOWER, BHUBANESWAR

Bid Identification No.Civil/EST-24/2026-27 : TCN No.25274, dt.25/08/2026

NOTICE INVITING TENDER UNDER NATIONAL COMPETITIVE BIDDING THROUGH e-Procurement

1. Name of the Work : Construction of Block level Stadium (with Indoor Hall), in Rangeilunda Block under Ganjam District.

2. Value of the Work : Rs.15.23 Crore

3. Period of completion : 12 (Twelve) Calendar Months

4. Availability of tender online for Bidding :

- Start Date : 18:00 Hours of dt.09.09.2026
- End Date : 15:00 Hours of dt.24.09.2026
- Opening date : 16:00 Hours of dt.24.09.2026.

Tender details can be seen from the e-procurement portal: www.tendersorissa.gov.in, Corrigendum or Addendum if any will not be published in newspapers and can be seen in e-procurement portal as well as in IDCO website.

Chief General Manager (Civil), IDCO, Bhubaneswar
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1 Nature of work	Building works
2 No. of Works	09 Nos.
3 Value of Tender	Rs.60.43 Lakh to Rs.560.07 Lakh
4 Class of Contractor	'B' Class to 'A' Class
5 Cost of Bid document (To be paid online)	₹ 11,800.00
6 Availability of Bid Documents in the website	Dt.05/09/2026 to Dt.19/09/2026 up to 5.00 P.M
7 Last date/Time of Receipt of Bids in the Portal	Dt.19/09/2026 up to 5.00 P.M
8 Date of Opening Bid	Dt.21/09/2026 at 10.30 A.M.
9 Date of Technical Presentation (among qualified bidders only)	Date & Time will be notified after opening of the Technical Bid.
10 *The Bidders have to participate in ONLINE bidding only. Further details can also be seen from the website: https://tendersodisha.gov.in . Any addendum/corrigendum/cancellation of tender shall not be published in Newspaper and can only be seen in the said website. *The Authority reserves the right to reject any or all bids and terminate the tender process without assigning any reason therefor.	

N.B.-The quoted rate should be all inclusive but excluding G.S.T. as applicable Under works contract. Sd/-

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Raj.Samwad/C/26/10524

(Additional Director)

OFFICE OF THE SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER, PUBLIC WORKS DEPARTMENT CIRCLE DIDWANA

पब्लिक वर्क्स / सी / 2026-27 / 1310 दिनांक - 26.08.2026

NIB Code: PWD2627A2571
UBN No:- 1. PWD2627WSOB11490

Short Term Notice Inviting Bid No 07/2026-27

01 Bids for Road works are invited from interested bidder upto 06:00 PM on Tuesday 08 September 2026 . Other particulars of the bid may be visited on the procurement portal (<http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in> or <http://sppp.raj.nic.in>) of the State. The approximate value of the procurement is Rs. 287.31 Lacs.

Superintending Engineer
PWD Circle Didwana
DIPR/C/15608/2026

CM YK 9 A BM-BME

INBRIEF



NRI deposits lift rupee to a two-month high of ₹94.6

The Indian rupee appreciated to a two-month high of ₹94.60 against the dollar on September 3, a day after the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) mopped up \$137 billion through FCNR(B) deposits, external commercial borrowings and overseas foreign currency borrowings. The domestic currency opened at ₹94.30, down 50 paise from the previous close of ₹94.70 against the dollar. The rupee then gradually weakened to settle at the day's closing level.

Aditya Birla Group forays into wires and cables business

Aditya Birla Group announced its entry into the wires and cables business under brand Ultravolt. This marks the group's fourth new business foray in three years which includes paints, jewellery and a B2B e-commerce platform Birla Pivot. With an investment of ₹1,800 crore, Ultravolt will be the second largest player in the wires segment by capacity, the company said. Housed under UltraTech Cement Ltd., the business aims to be one of the top two players within five years.

PayPal says 220 employees hit in latest India restructuring

PayPal said approximately 220 employees in India were affected by workforce reductions on August 31 – representing about 4% of its India employee headcount – disputing reports of substantially higher job cuts in the country. The digital payments company said the reduction was part of its previously announced multi-year transformation programme aimed at simplifying global operations, strengthening execution, and positioning the company for long-term growth.

FLY91 inks firm order for 40 ATR aircraft



Flying higher: Fly91 will will lease another six to eight aircraft before the new aircraft begin arriving.

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Regional airline FLY91 signed a firm order for 40 70-seater ATR 72-600 aircraft, marking the largest ATR order globally by any regional airline. The deal is valued at about \$1 billion though clients negotiate discounts on listed price. The airline will lease another six to eight aircraft before the new aircraft begin arriving. For the Fran-

co-Italian aircraft maker, a big Indian order comes nine years after IndiGo ordered 50 ATRs in 2017. The airline, unveiled in 2024, operates 280 weekly flights to 12 destinations. It connects Pune, Sindhudurg, Solapur and Jalgaon in Maharashtra; Agatti in Lakshadweep Islands; Hubballi in Karnataka; Tirupati, Vijayawada and Rajahmundry in AP; along with Bengaluru, Goa, Kochi and Hyderabad.

No excuses left for textiles sector, says Goyal on tariffs

T.C.A. Sharad Raghavan
NEW DELHI

Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal said India's textile industry can no longer blame external factors for its weak export performance, noting that most developed markets now impose tariffs on Indian textile imports that are at par with or lower than those levied on key competitors such as Bangladesh and Vietnam. Speaking at a workshop here, Mr. Goyal explained for years the Indian textiles industry could not compete with Bangladesh and Vietnam because of a com-



Piyush Goyal

bination of the advantage Bangladesh continued to receive as a least-developed country (LDC), and the terms Vietnam has negotiated in various trade deals with developed countries. Many developed

SC disposes of SEBI appeals against NSE in two cases

Apex court takes note of nearly ₹1,500 cr. settlement between the regulator and the exchange in co-location and dark fibre cases; resolution comes ahead of the exchange's stock market debut

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court on Thursday disposed of a batch of appeals filed by the Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) against the National Stock Exchange (NSE) in the co-location and dark fibre cases, following a settlement of nearly ₹1,500 crore between the market regulator and the exchange.

A Bench of Justices J.B. Pardiwala and K. Vinod Chandran was hearing SEBI's appeals against orders of the Securities Appellate Tribunal (SAT) setting aside disgorgement directions issued by the regulator against the NSE in the two cases. The Bench dis-



The cases stem from allegations that certain brokers were given preferential access to NSE's trading systems via co-location. REUTERS

posed of the appeals after taking note of the settlement between the parties. In July, SEBI had accepted two settlement applications filed by the NSE for an aggregate amount of about ₹1,492 crore. Of this,

about ₹1,224 crore pertained to the co-location case, while ₹268 crore related to the dark fibre case, also known as the leased-line connectivity case. The cases stem from allegations that certain brok-

ers were given preferential access to the NSE's trading systems through its co-location facility, potentially allowing them to receive market data ahead of others. The allegations of unfair access first surfaced following a whistle-blower complaint in January 2015.

The settlement comes as the country's largest stock exchange prepares for its stock-market debut, nearly a decade after it first sought to list its shares, with its plans having faced prolonged regulatory hurdles.

The proposed initial public offering (IPO) is expected to raise around ₹30,000 crore, which would make it one of the largest IPOs in India's capital market history.

GJC calls for balancing economic patriotism with cultural heritage

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

While welcoming Prime Minister Narendra Modi's call for prioritising locally-made products and reducing gold imports, the All India Gem & Jewellery Domestic Council (GJC) has said that India must balance "economic patriotism" and cultural traditions

when it comes to gold jewellery. The council argued that the sector contributes "nearly 7-8%" to the economy and supports "millions of livelihoods". The GJC was reacting to Prime Minister Narendra Modi's recent and repeated appeal to all Indians to stop foreign trips and weddings, to buy local, and to only buy gold if necessary.

SEBI to make changes in CAS derivative price determination in a week

The Hindu Bureau
MUMBAI

The Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) is set to introduce changes to the methodology used to determine settlement prices for derivative contracts following the implementation of the newly introduced Closing Auction Session (CAS).

SEBI is expected to announce the changes in about a week.

The markets regulator said in a statement that it had engaged with market participants and other stakeholders after receiving feedback and suggestions on the CAS through multiple channels, including social media and other media platforms.

'Little investment in energy innovation'

Lalendu Mishra
PUNE

Indian Oil Corporation Ltd (IOCL) chairman A. S. Sahney lamented about the minuscule investment going into energy innovation.

"For all our strength as an energy nation, we have to address a very uncomfortable fact that energy innovation in India got very less attention, very less capital than its importance demands," he told a gathering of start-up founders, academia and industry officials at CSIR-National Chemicals Laboratory (NCL) here.

"In the last 5-6 years, barely 2% of India's overall startup funding has come to the energy sector. Of the total about ₹5.5 lakh crore that has gone into the startup ecosystem, only ₹11,000 cr. has gone to the

'In the last 5-6 years, barely 2% of India's overall startup funding has come to the energy sector'

energy sector. And that is a pity. That situation needs to be corrected very quickly," he said at an event held by MC² Foundation. "And if we take out areas like solar, wind, the funding comes down to less than ₹1,000 crore of the ₹5.5 lakh crore that have been spent," he added. He said innovation was crucial due to what was happening to the energy market as a whole. Stating India's energy demand will double in 15-20 years, he said "we need lots of innovations, lot of startups." (The writer was in Pune at the invitation of IOCL)

Filatex's new unit to recycle polyester textiles

The Hindu Bureau
COIMBATORE

Filatex India is investing about ₹300 crore to set up a polyester textile recycling plant in Gujarat with an annual capacity of 27,000 tonne, CMD Madhu Sudhan Bhageria said.

The plant is expected to be commissioned next month and would recycle polyester textile waste into polyester chips. The company's in-house technology is capable of recovering around 80-85% of the polyester content from textile waste, the firm said.



जवाहरलाल सातकोर आस्थिमान शिक्षा एवं अनुसंधान संस्थान
JAWAHARLAL INSTITUTE OF POSTGRADUATE MEDICAL EDUCATION & RESEARCH
(स्वास्थ्य एवं परिवार कल्याण मंत्रालय, भारत सरकार के अधीन राष्ट्रीय मजदूर का संस्थान)
(An Institution of National Importance under Ministry of Health & Family Welfare)
भारत सरकार / GOVERNMENT OF INDIA, नई दिल्ली - 110 055 (Dhanvantari Nagar, Postbox-055 008)
तелефोन: 011-22682828 ईमेल: info@jipmer.edu.in



No. JIP/ACad/2026-27/ BScCourses Dated: 04.09.2026
JIPMER invites applications for admission to BSc (Nursing/AHS) Courses-- Academic Year 2026-27

IMPORTANT DATES

1. Commencement of Online Registration : 05.09.2026 (Saturday) 09.00 AM
2. Closing Date for Online Registration : 28.09.2026 (Monday) 04.00 PM
For further details, refer to BSc Prospectus 2026-27 available on JIPMER website www.jipmer.edu.in
Admission to all B.Sc Courses will be based on NEET (UG) 2026 merit score.

DEAN (ACADEMIC)



Government of Kerala

Published Tenders from 31-08-2026 to 02-09-2026

Stationery Department

Tender ID: 2026_STY_864241 2 * Stationery Controller * Supply of Multilayered Board 58 cm x 78 cm x 200 GSM * Closing Date: 14-Sep-2026 * PAC: Rs49997506

Tender ID: 2026_STY_864031 2 * Stationery Controller * Supply of Maplitho Paper 83 cm Reel, 70 GSM * Closing Date: 10-Sep-2026 * PAC: Rs644924203

Tender ID: 2026_STY_864160 2 * Stationery Controller * Supply of Maplitho Paper 41.5 cm Reel, 70 GSM * Closing Date: 10-Sep-2026 * PAC: Rs30275029

Tender ID: 2026_STY_864232 2 * Stationery Controller * Supply of Multilayered Board 58 cm x 86 cm x 200 GSM * Closing Date: 14-Sep-2026 * PAC: Rs95550541

Tender ID: 2026_STY_864190 2 * Stationery Controller * Supply of Maplitho Paper 38 cm Reel, 70 GSM * Closing Date: 10-Sep-2026 * PAC: Rs16272025

Tender ID: 2026_STY_864170 2 * Stationery Controller * Supply of Maplitho Paper 76 cm Reel, 70 GSM * Closing Date: 10-Sep-2026 * PAC: Rs266473977

Visit <https://etenders.kerala.gov.in> for more details.

Ro.No:31-02/Aug-Sep/2026/PRD/(N)8



BENGALURU CENTRAL CITY CORPORATION
Office of the Executive Engineer Gandhinagar Division,
2nd Floor BMP Complex, Dhanavantri Road, Bangalore-560009

No: EE/GNR/TEND/KPPP/01/01/2026-27 Date: 03.09.2026

SHORT TERM TENDER NOTIFICATION (IFT) Call-2 (TWO COVER SYSTEM)

(Through GOK KPP Portal <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in> only)

Tenders on item rate basis are invited by the undersigned for the work mentioned below from the registered contractors of Bengaluru Central City Corporation or equivalent registration with CPWD/ KPWD/ RMDs/ MES or any State Government Organizations.

Sl. No.	Name of the Work
1.	Ward No.62, Annual Maintenance of Storm Water Drains in Gandhinagar Constituency/(Call-2) Amount put to Tender : Rs.375.26 Lakhs EMD : Rs. 5,63,000.00

Calendar of Events : (1) Last date & Time for receipt of tenders upto **11.09.2026 to 16.00 Hours** (2) Date & Time for Opening of Technical Bid : **15.09.2026 upto 12.30 Hours** (3) Date & Time for Opening of Financial Bid : **(Will be intimated Through KPPP)**

Sd/- Executive Engineer, Gandhinagar Division, BCCC

Parliamentary panel flags 'punitive' tax regime, seeks data on new I-T Act's impact

Sobhana K. Nair
NEW DELHI

Members of the Parliamentary Standing Committee on Finance, cutting across party lines, criticised the present Income Tax regime for relying excessively on what they described as "punitive action" and granting tax officials significant scope for overreach, at a meeting on Thursday .

The panel, headed by BJP MP Bhartruhari Mahatab, met to discuss "Direct Tax Reforms: Simplification, Rationalisation and Ease of Compliance" with representatives of the Department of Revenue in the Finance Ministry and the Central Board of Direct Taxes (CBDT).

The committee also flagged compliance-related glitches in the implementation of the Income Tax Act, 2026, and sought additional information from the CBDT on its impact, including changes in tax revenue collections, the number of assessees, and the volume of pending litigation.

GDP estimates

According to sources, at least one member raised the controversy surrounding the latest Gross Domestic Product (GDP) estimates, questioning the reliability of official growth figures in the context of former Union Finance Secretary Subhash Garg's claim that India's economy expanded by only 2.6% in



The committee flagged compliance-related glitches in implementation of the Act.

the June quarter rather than the officially reported 7.8%. "The issue was not on the agenda today, so it was not discussed further," a committee member said.

Two themes dominated the discussions.

First, members expressed concern over the growing contribution of individual income taxpayers relative to corporate tax collections. Some pointed out that in several economies comparable to India, corporate tax collections significantly exceed those from individual taxpayers.

Second, members criticised what they viewed as the Income Tax Department's heavy-handed approach to enforcement.

"Why should all income taxpayers be treated as criminals? There is a spate of notices being issued, leaving taxpayers scrambling to prove that they have complied with all rules, while the rules themselves keep changing, sometimes even retrospectively," a ruling party member said.



TIRUMALA TIRUPATI DEVASTHANAMS - TIRUPATI
S.V.GOSAMRAKSHANA SHALA e-TENDER NOTICE

NTT No. TTD/30/45/2025-SV Goshala, Dated: 02.09.2026

e-Tender is invited for "Manufacturing / Packaging / Supply of Agarabathi Products for TTD Agarabathi Unit" for a period of (03) three years as per T&C applies. Tender documents can be downloaded by login to <https://tender.approcurement.gov.in>, **DOWNLOAD START DATE: 04-09-2026 from 04.00 PM and LAST DATE FOR SUBMISSION OF TENDER IS: 18-09-2026 up to 03.00 PM.** For further details contact **Mobile No: 9281413626.**

TTD-40021(31)/1/2026-PRO SEC(Adv.No.173) Date:03-09-2026 **EXECUTIVE OFFICER**

WALK-IN INTERVIEW
(Under SC/ST Scheme)

Rajiv Gandhi Centre for Aquaculture (RGCA) a society under the Marine Products Export Development Authority (MPEDA) propose to conduct **Walk-in interview on 18/09/2026 for engaging Lab Trainees.** For details, log on to www.rgca.co.in.

DIRECTOR, MPEDA - RGCA



MAHATRANSCO
Maharashtra State Electricity Transmission Co. Ltd.

INVITATION FOR BID (IFB) (LOCAL COMPETITIVE BIDDING)

SRM e-Tender No. T-2679/MSETCL/CO/Projects/Pre-Tender (RFx No. 6000001584) (2nd Call)

MSETCL invites offers by SRM e-tendering in TWO bid system (Techno-Commercial Bid and Price Bid) from the eligible registered bidders for the following work as detailed below.

"Establishment of 220/132kV Babhulgaon Substation, along with construction of associated lines, Dist. Yawatmal under Amravati Zone, MSETCL, Maharashtra."

Interested bidders may obtain further information available on the website. <https://srmetender.mahatransco.in>

The date of downloading of Bid documents available on the website is from **31.08.2026.**

Sd/-
Chief Engineer (Projects), MSETCL



KARNATAKA POWER CORPORATION LIMITED
CIN: U05110KA1970SGC001919

BRIEF TENDER NOTIFICATION
(Two Cover System) (Through KPP Portal only)

KPCL invites tenders through "e" Procurement Portal <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in> for the following works:

BELLARY THERMAL POWER STATION

Procurement of - Tender No. 1) KPCL/2025-26/IND2562/CALL-2 Lube oil cooler & spares. 2) KPCL/2025-26/IND2048/CALL-2 LT Cables. 3) KPCL/2026-27/IND2768 Liquid Sodium Hypochlorite. Last date for receipt of tender: For Sl. No. 1: 07.09.2026. For Sl. No. 2: 09.09.2026. For Sl. No. 3: 16.09.2026. Further details can be obtained from **Executive Engineer (Purchase)**, Mobile: 094808 30377. E-mail: eeurchasestps@gmail.com

4) KPCL/2026-27/PS/WORK_INDENT4644/CALL-2 Dated: 01.09.2026 Maintenance and Assistance to Operation of Pumps for Dust Suppression System of Coal Handling Plant Unit 1 & 2 for a period of one year. Total Tender Amount (Exclusive of GST): **Rs.40,42,489/-**. EMD: **Rs.80,900/-**. Last date for submission of bids: **09.09.2026 up to 17.00 Hrs.** Further details can be obtained from **Executive Engineer (CHP) Mechanical-1**, Mobile: +91 94482 90756.

5) KPCL/2026-27/PS/WORK_INDENT4750 Date: 01.09.2026 Conducting Mandatory Energy Audit of (Unit-1 and 2, 500MW each) and (Unit-3, 700MW) of BTPS for the year 2026-27, as per the guideline of BEE, under energy conservation act 2001. Last date for receipt of tenders: **16.09.2026.** Further details can be obtained from **Executive Engineer (EPT)**, BTPS, KPCL, Kudithini-583 142, Karnataka. Mobile: 94808 30346. E-mail: eeeptps@gmail.com

RAICHUR THERMAL POWER STATION

6) KPCL/2026-27/PS/WORK_INDENT4737 Date: 01.09.2026 Periodical Special Assistance and Annual Maintenance works of Generator transformers, Station transformers, ICTS, Line and Bus reactors, Unit Auxiliary Transformers, Colony Power Supply Transformers & OLA transformers and allied equipments for a period of 12 months. EMD: **Rs.1,15,245/-**. Last date for submission of bids (Both cover 1 & 2): **09.09.2026 up to 16.30 Hrs.** Further details can be obtained from **Executive Engineer (Transformer)**, RTPS, KPCL, Shaktinagar-584170, Raichur Dist. Mobile: 94495 96519.

PESHAWAR
15 militants trying to infiltrate were killed in KPK province, says Pak.



At least 15 militants have been killed and their attempt to infiltrate the border in Pakistan's Khyber Pakhtunkhwa province foiled by security forces, the military's media wing said on Thursday. The militants were trying to infiltrate the Pakistan-Afghanistan border opposite North Waziristan district, the ISPR said. PTI

DUBAI
13 Yemeni forces killed in clashes with Houthis, says military source



Thirteen Yemeni government forces were killed in clashes with Houthi fighters on Thursday, a military source said, saying the group was trying to advance towards areas bordering the strategic Bab al-Mandab strait. The source said the Houthis were trying to sever the route connecting Taiz and the port city of Mokha. AFP

RAMALLAH
Palestinians say Israeli Army killed two teenagers in the West Bank



The Israeli Army killed two teenagers in the occupied West Bank on Wednesday night, the Palestinian Health Ministry said, while the Army said it opened fire during a "violent riot". The Palestinian Red Crescent reported that the two critically wounded teenagers were pronounced dead at hospitals in Ramallah. AFP

NEW DELHI
ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude face widespread outages; AWS also hit



Major artificial intelligence platforms, including OpenAI's ChatGPT, Google Gemini, and Anthropic's Claude, experienced service disruptions on Thursday, affecting thousands of users globally, according to the outage tracking website Downt detector. The disruption appeared to impact Grok and Amazon Web Services. PTI

Iran attacks U.S. bases in West Asia despite Trump's threats of strikes

Tehran's military claims it hit Kuwait's Ahmed al-Jaber Air Base; Kuwait says its forces intercepted a missile and drone strike coming from Iran, and condemned the attack as a 'threat' to the country's security and a grave breach of international law

Agence France-Presse
TEHRAN

Iran attacked U.S. military bases in Kuwait on Thursday, despite President Donald Trump threatening further strikes in a renewed flare-up six months into the war. The new clashes, which began with U.S. raids on Sunday, deepen the ongoing impasse in the war, as Iran maintains a stranglehold on the strategic Strait of Hormuz and the U.S. presses its counter-blockade of Iranian ports. Mr. Trump said his military was prepared to attack Iran "any time we want" after extensive U.S. bom-



Rubble lies around damaged houses following a reported attack near a wedding gathering in Iran on Wednesday. REUTERS

bardment of sites across the country left at least 19 Iranians dead between Tuesday and Wednesday. Tehran has once again retaliated with strikes

Iran's pummelling of U.S. military targets across the region came after a U.S. attack that hit a wedding in the country's south, prompting fury from Tehran. The Iranian Red Crescent said shrapnel from the missile attack in the coastal town of Kuhestak killed four persons, including a child, and wounded more than 50. Iran's Revolutionary Guards chief Ahmad Vahidi vowed on Thursday to avenge the four killed. "The pure blood of these oppressed martyrs... will not go unanswered and will definitely be avenged". U.S. Central Command (CENTCOM) spokesperson

Tim Hawkins said "the U.S. military never targets civilians, unlike the IRGC", referring to Iran's Revolutionary Guards. Kuwait's army on Thursday said it was intercepting a missile and drone attack from Iran, with the Iranian army saying it hit "the Ahmad al-Jaber Air Base in Kuwait with missiles and drones". Iran's army also said it struck Al Minhad Air Base in the United Arab Emirates, but the Gulf country reported no such attack. Kuwait called the attacks "a direct threat to its security and stability, and a grave breach of the rules of international law".

'Supersized' El Nino to be strongest ever recorded: UN

Reuters
GENEVA

The El Nino weather phenomenon is set to intensify further into 2027 and could be the strongest ever, raising risks of extreme weather into next year, the World Meteorological Organisation said on Thursday. The UN weather agency said its forecasts showed a near 100% likelihood that El Nino would persist through February 2027, fuelled by exceptionally warm Pacific Ocean temperatures. This is the first time it has expressed such a degree of certainty, the WMO said. "If this trajectory continues, it may be stronger than anything since our monitoring began. So literally off the charts," WMO



World Meteorological Organisation Secretary-General Celeste Saulo, left, attend a press conference in Geneva on Thursday. AFP

Secretary-General Celeste Saulo told a Geneva press conference. El Nino is a periodic warming of sea surface temperatures in the eastern Pacific caused by weakening trade winds. It occurs every two to seven years and tends to last up to 12 months, causing intense rains and droughts across Latin America. A very strong El Nino can significantly shift rainfall and temperature patterns worldwide, and fuel extreme weather, such as droughts and typhoons. The WMO said it was stepping up preparedness and early warning efforts in preparation to allow states to take early action.

The feminist organiser and her everyday rebellions

Sunalini Mathew
NEW DELHI

On her website, Gloria Steinem describes herself as a "feminist organizer", a doer, as most women are. Until the end, she hosted Talking Circles, at her New York home, where people gathered to do the rough-and-tumble work of activism, but also the gentler work of community building. This "movement building" is what Steinem will always be remembered for. The practice of gathering in a group, where everyone is heard, was inspired from India, where Steinem spent two years, after she graduated at 22, from Smith College, Massachusetts in the U.S. in 1956. She came to India every few years, and was closely associated with Ruchira Gupta, who founded Apne Aap Women Worldwide, a non-profit working to end sex trafficking. Steinem chaired Apne Aap's advisory board, and for Ms. Gupta, she was "a third parent." Ms. Gupta says their relationship went back to the 1990s. "She had heard about my work through mutual friends and wanted to see it. I took her in an autorickshaw into the slums of Delhi, where I was organising some women. It began to rain, and I hoped the women would show up," she says. There, in front of a tumbledown building, Steinem spoke to the women about the abortion she had had in her youth. "She spoke in English; I translated, but the women connected with her story. They began to speak about their experiences with abortion." Later, Steinem told Ms. Gupta something she will always



GLORIA STEINEM (1934-2026)

remember: "Honour your sister with the truth." With Steinem, she co-edited *As if Women Matter: The Essential Gloria Steinem Reader*, essays by Steinem, on feminist thought. Besides this, Steinem wrote nine books, including *The Truth Will Set You Free, But First it Will Piss You Off*, *Outrageous Acts and Everyday Rebellions*, and her memoir that is slated for release internationally in September, called *An Unexpected Life*. She was also the founder-editor of *Ms.* magazine. Independent journalist and author, Ammu Joseph, who lives and works out of Bengaluru, remembers spending about a week as a journalism student in the *Ms.* office in 1976, four years after *Ms.* began, selling 3 lakh copies of its first issue. "By then Steinem was already a well-known, but until the end, she didn't let celebrity touch her," Ms. Joseph says, describing her as easy to be with. "She debunked the whole notion of feminists being humourless and dowdy, and maybe because of her women are proud to call themselves feminists." *Ms.* magazine's first issue had an illustration of a blue Kali, with eight arms, each holding an iron, hand mirror, phone, steering

Foreign arms, drones fuel Sudan war, says UN probe

Reuters
GENEVA

Foreign weapons, military technology, fighters and logistical networks are helping sustain Sudan's conflict and expanding the warring parties' ability to strike distant civilian areas with drones, a UN fact-finding mission said on Thursday. The mission said investigators found grounds to believe a network involving individuals and entities in the UAE, Chad, Libya and Somalia supplied the RSF with weapons, equipment, logistics, training and foreign personnel. It added that external support for Sudan's military was at an early stage.

Toll rises to 1,252 in Nepal; risks of new floods rise

Press Trust of India
KATHMANDU

The death toll due to the devastating flash floods in Nepal rose to 1,252 on Thursday as more bodies were recovered from the affected areas, while risks of fresh floods loomed due to incessant rainfall in the upstream areas of the Bhotekoshi River. As the upstream areas of the Bhotekoshi River are continuously receiving rainfall, people residing in the surrounding areas and downstream of the river are urged to remain vigilant, a technician at the Department of Hydrology and Meteorology said.

BRIHANMUMBAI MUNICIPAL CORPORATION
Department: Chief Engineer (Mechanical & Electrical)
No.E.E.Mech. (S)/3068/M&E/Dt. -3 SEP 2026

E-Tender Notice

The Commissioner of Brihanmumbai Municipal Corporation invites online tenders for the following works from the eligible bidders. The Bid start date and time and Bid End Date and Time is specified in the detailed tender notice on BMC's website under Tender Section and Mahatender Portal.

Sr.No.	Bid No.	Name of the work
01	2026_MCGM_1334069.1	Work of comprehensive Operation and Maintenance contract of PNG Furnaces (2 Nos.) at Sion Crematorium for One year.

The intending tenderers shall visit the BMC website at <http://portal.mcgm.gov.in> and Mahatender portal website at <http://mahatenders.gov.in> for further details of the tender.

PRO/1306/ADV/2026-27

AVOID SELF MEDICATION

Sd/-
EX. ENG. ENG. MECH (SOUTH)

BRIHANMUMBAI MUNICIPAL CORPORATION
PUBLIC HEALTH DEPARTMENT
SHIVAJINAGAR MAT. HOME, GOVANDI
No. HO/315/SNMH Dt. 03.09.2026

Sub- Providing labour at NICU Shivaji Nagar Maternity Home, M-east on Contract Basis.

Advertisement

Shivaji Nagar Maternity Home under M-east ward has invited proposal from authorized Local register NGO'S. Interested NGO'S may submit application forms along with all necessary documents with application fees Rs.3993 + 18% GST Rs.718.7/- total Rs.4711.7/- from Dt.04.09.2026 to Dt. 15.09.2026 from 10:30 am to 03:00 on below mention address. This application forms will be opened as lottery system in the chamber on Medical Officer Shivaji Nagar Maternity Home.

Address: Medical Officer
Shivaji Nagar Maternity Home 3rd Floor
Ahilyabai Holkar Marg, Shivaji Nagar,
Govandi (West)-400043

PRO/1312/ADV/2026-27

AVOID SELF MEDICATION

Sd/-
Medical Officer
Shivaji Nagar Maternity Home

DELHI PHARMACEUTICAL SCIENCES AND RESEARCH UNIVERSITY
(State University of GNCT of Delhi, Established under Act 07 of 2008,GNCTD)
Pushp Vihar, Sector-03, M.B. Road, New Delhi-110017, India

OPEN ROUND OF COUNSELLING FOR ACADEMIC SESSION 2026 - 27

It is hereby informed that the Delhi Pharmaceutical Sciences and Research University (DPSRU) is inviting fresh applications for admission under the "Open Round of Counselling" from aspiring candidates seeking admission against the few unfilled vacancies in Diploma, Undergraduate (except B.Pharm and BPT), and Postgraduate programmes for the Academic Session 2026-27. The application form filling and submission process shall be conducted online, whereas the admission / counselling process shall be conducted in physical mode. Details regarding the courses, available vacant seats and other relevant information are available on the University website: www.dpsru.edu.in.

S/d
Registrar, DPSRU

UT ADMINISTRATION OF DADRA & NAGAR HAVELI AND DAMAN & DIU
WILDLIFE DIVISION, FOREST DEPARTMENT, DADRA & NAGAR HAVELI

NOTICE INVITING TENDER

Subject: Providing and Fixing Chain link fencing for holding area for safe release of deers at Kaucha Jamalpada, Sry. No. 56.

Tender Notice No.	8-6/FD/CSO/WL/2026/ESTIMATE-732/NIT/750
Online Downloading of Tender Documents	From 03.09.2026 03.00 pm.
Last date of Submission of Tender	Up to 18.09.2026 02.00 pm.
Online Opening of Tender	On 18.09.2026 16.00 hrs.
Tender Id No.	2026_UTDNH_8231.1

For details please scan
www.dnh.gov.in, www.dnhtenders.gov.in

Deputy Conservator of Forests, WILDLIFE, Dadra & Nagar Haveli, Silvassa
NO:IP/DMN/2/5/2026-27/474 dated: 03/09/2026

PUNJAB STATE TRANSMISSION CORPORATION LIMITED,
Regd Office: PSEB Head Office, The Mall, Patiala, 147001
Corporate Identity No. U40109PB2010SGC033814 www.pstcl.org
O/o: Dy. CE/ TS (Design), Telefax: 0175-2207774, E-mail:se-tdr@pstcl.org

Notice Inviting E-Tender

Tender Enquiry No. STQ-6126

For Design, Manufacture, Supply, Testing, Laying, Jointing & Commissioning of 132 KV Single Core 400 mm² XLPE (Aluminium Conductor with Corrugated Aluminium Sheath) U/G Cable and Fiber Optics Cable for communication purposes along with accessories for the 132 KV Tower to Gantry underground cable route at 132 KV S/ Stn. Hakima Gate on Turnkey Basis.

1. Last date & time for downloading of tender- 05.10.2026 upto 11:00 AM
2. Last date & time for submission of tender- 05.10.2026 upto 11:00 AM
3. Date & time for opening of tender - 07.10.2026 at 11:00 AM

Detailed NIT/specification may be downloaded from Punjab Govt. e-tendering website <http://eproc.punjab.gov.in/nicgep/app>. Corrigendum, if any, will not be published in newspapers. As such the website may be visited regularly for updates. 1078/12/2026-27/14853 Dy. CE/TS (D), PSTCL, Patiala.

UT ADMINISTRATION OF DADRA & NAGAR HAVELI AND DAMAN & DIU
WILDLIFE DIVISION, FOREST DEPARTMENT, DADRA & NAGAR HAVELI

NOTICE INVITING TENDER

Subject: Repairing and upgradation of chainlink fencing at Lion holding area and quarantine area of Lion Safari Vasona.

Tender Notice No.	8-6/FD/CSO/WL/2026/ESTIMATE-724/NIT/747
Online Downloading of Tender Documents	From 03.09.2026 03.00 pm.
Last date of Submission of Tender	Up to 18.09.2026 02.00 pm.
Online Opening of Tender	On 18.09.2026 16.00 hrs.
Tender Id No.	2026_UTDNH_8229.1

For details please scan
www.dnh.gov.in, www.dnhtenders.gov.in

Deputy Conservator of Forests, WILDLIFE, Dadra & Nagar Haveli, Silvassa
NO:IP/DMN/2/5/2026-27/475 dated: 03/09/2026

THE HINDU
Your feedback will keep us Cleaner, Sharper and Bolder

Call our toll-free number
1800 102 1878
Or write to us at
admission@thehindu.co.in

Scan the QR code to register your feedback

THE HINDU
thehindu.businessline.

FRONTLINE

SPORTSTAR

YOUNG WORLD

THE HINDUSTAN TIMES

THE HINDU
Surcharge:
Ahmedabad – Rs. 5.00

EYEING AN ENCORE

Laxman appointed India coach for the upcoming Asian Games



EMMANUAL YOGINI

V.V.S. Laxman will be the coach of the Indian men's team at the Asian Games to be held in Aichi-Nagoya, Japan, later this month. Laxman will be assisted by Sunil Joshi, Hrishikesh Kanitkar and Subhadeep Ghosh. Laxman had guided the team to the gold medal at the 2023 Asian Games in Hangzhou.

ALL IS WELL

BCCI is working like a well-oiled engine, says secretary Saikia



EMMANUAL YOGINI

Everybody is on the same page. The BCCI is working like a well-oiled engine. There is proper coordination among all the wings of the BCCI, whether it is the women's team committees, their technical staff and coaches, the COE, the Indian men's team coaching staff or the head coach — BCCI secretary Devajit Saikia.

HANDLING WITH CARE

'The plan is to ensure the players get adequate rest in the future'



EMMANUAL YOGINI

BCCI secretary Devajit Saikia said that the Board's FTP (Future Tours Programme) officials had been instructed to ensure the matches are scheduled in such a way to ensure adequate rest for the players. "We are hoping for acclimatisation and friendly matches before any major series in SENA countries," said Saikia.

ADDING TO THE UNCERTAINTY

Dhoni does not want to be an Impact Player: Badrinath



FILE PHOTO: M. VEDHAN

M.S. Dhoni has told former Chennai Super Kings batter S. Badrinath that he does not intend to be involved as an Impact Player, adding another twist to the uncertainty surrounding his participation in IPL 2027. "He has personally told me that he won't play as an Impact Player. He sees himself as a full-time keeper," said Badrinath.

Smriti scales the summit as India routs Hong Kong

The left-hander surpasses Mithali to become the highest run-getter in women's internationals; the opener also goes past Lanning and Wolvaardt for most hundreds with her 18th ton

ASIA CUP

Press Trust of India
DUBAI

Smriti Mandhana slayed a hapless Hong Kong bowling attack on way to a record-breaking century as India raced to 193 for five in the women's Asia Cup match here on Thursday. Smriti (124, 64b, 14x4, 7x6) made up for a sedate start rather quickly and shared a 74-run stand with her opening partner Shafali Verma (28, 17b, 3x4, 2x6) to set the tone for the innings. In reply, Hong Kong was bundled out for 56.

Poor bowling

The Hong Kong bowlers made life easier for the batters by offering too many loose deliveries. Smriti surpassed Australian legend Mag Lanning and South African skipper Laura Wolvaardt for most centuries in women's internationals by getting to her 18th hundred across formats in the 17th over. It was also Smriti's second T20I hundred. In the following over, Smriti plundered a couple of sixes down the ground to go past Mithali Raj (10,868) in the leading run-scorers' chart.

Smriti scored runs all around the ground and was at her regal self while hitting sixes over the bowler's head. Shafali was slow to get off the blocks before cutting loose in the last over of PowerPlay that went for 22 runs

Smriti has 10,880 to her credit. As she often does, Smriti scored runs all around the ground and was at her regal self while hitting sixes over the bowler's head.

Notwithstanding the limitations of the Hong Kong bowlers, the left-hander made it look easy on a surface where batters took time to get going.

Shafali was slow to get off the blocks before cutting loose in the last over of PowerPlay that went for 22 runs.

The Hong Kong bowlers tried to trap Smriti with a wide line but the 30-year-old was hardly bothered by that tactic.

Pratika Rawal (10 off 12), playing at No.3 in her debut T20I series, could not accelerate and was caught at cover.

The scores: India 193/5 in 20 overs (Smriti 124, Marina 2/46) bt Hong Kong 56 in 16.2 overs (Nandani 2/6, Shree Charani 2/16, Deepti 3/9, Prema 2/12). **Toss:** Hong Kong. India won by 137 runs.



Blazing away: Smriti smashed 14 fours and seven maximums in her 64-ball 124. x@BCCIWOMEN

Agarkar's absence from meeting raises eyebrows

CRICKET

Amol Karhadkar
MUMBAI

Ajit Agarkar's absence from the BCCI performance review meeting on Thursday has intensified speculation over his future as chief selector beyond this month.

Agarkar, who has chaired the National selection committee since July 2023, was the only key stakeholder missing from the high-profile meet convened at the BCCI headquarters to review India's recent performances and chart a roadmap for the 2027 ODI World Cup.

BCCI secretary Devajit Saikia sought to downplay his absence, insisting that Agarkar was unavailable because of "personal commitments" and that the meeting had been organised "at short notice".

Yet, with Agarkar's existing contract set to expire at the end of the month, his non-attendance has fuelled murmurs about a growing distance between



The powers that be: BCCI secretary Saikia and president Manhas arrive for the meeting. EMMANUAL YOGINI

him and the Board's hierarchy.

The Hindu understands that the relationship between the two sides has been strained since July, when Saikia publicly issued a statement backing Rohit Sharma's continuation in India's ODI set-up without consulting Agarkar and his fellow selectors. The move came amid internal discussions over Rohit's future and created unease within the selection panel.

Since then, there has reportedly been no formal communication between the BCCI administration and Agarkar regarding a

possible extension. Under the Board's regulations, the former India pacer is eligible for a contract renewal, which would allow continuity through the ODI World Cup cycle.

"There was no such discussion in the meeting," Saikia said when asked whether Agarkar would get another year at the helm. "There was no discussion on the selection committee. Our focus was on the performance in England and Ireland as well as the Test series in Sri Lanka and what we are going to do in the upcoming series and the World Cup, which is our ultimate goal".

BCCI leaves Rohit's future up in the air

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The Board of Control for Cricket in India's (BCCI's) performance review meeting on Thursday did little to clear the air around Rohit Sharma's ODI future, with its public position, akin to a batsman deftly leaving a tricky delivery outside the off stump.

BCCI secretary Devajit Saikia, while addressing the media after the meeting, appeared to brush aside speculation over Rohit's future, pointing to the opener's recent form.

"He is playing superbly in all matches. What more do you want? He scored 138 in the last match (on July 19). Don't give fodder to such rumours," Saikia said.

The remarks came after a meeting of the key stakeholders of India's men's teams to review the performances in England and Ireland and chart a roadmap towards the 2027 ODI World Cup. Saikia, however, stressed that the gathering was not a selection meeting.

"Today we did not have any selection meeting, we had a routine meeting like



In good nick: BCCI secretary Saikia brushed aside speculation over Rohit's future, pointing to the opener's century in the third ODI against England at Lord's. GETTY IMAGES

we have frequent meetings after an interval of two-three months.

"We discussed how our team performed in England and Ireland and a roadmap has been prepared so that we have a very good performance in the 2027 World Cup," he said.

Head coach Gautam Gambhir, Test and ODI captain Shubman Gill, T20I captain Shreyas Iyer,

dia colours. Saikia had then firmly rejected the speculation.

"Rohit is a regular member of the Indian ODI team, and he will continue to represent the country as long as he is in the scheme of things. In other words, the Lord's ODI won't be his last match," Saikia had said on July 17.

The Hindu understands, however, that the selection committee, in consultation with the team management, had informed Rohit during the Chennai ODI against Afghanistan in June that he was not part of its plans beyond the England series. Rohit is understood to have reluctantly accepted the decision.

The selection committee's position, however, was subsequently overruled by the BCCI's administrative behemoths, leading to Saikia's public clarification ahead of the Lord's game.

Thursday's meeting did not revisit that decision in a formal manner. With Agarkar absent and no selection meeting on the agenda, the question of whether Rohit remains part of India's ODI plans was left deliberately unresolved.

Rahul, Siraj and Padikkal added to South team

DULEEP TROPHY

Sports Bureau
CHENNAI

India Test players K.L. Rahul, Mohammed Siraj and Devdutt Padikkal, who were part of the tour to Sri Lanka recently, have been added to the South Zone squad for the Duleep Trophy final against East Zone. The title decider will be played from September 6 to 10 at the MAC Stadium.

Apart from the three Test returnees, left-arm pacer C.V. Milind has been chosen as a cover for Karnataka pacer Vidhwath Kaverappa, who picked up an injury during the semifinal against North Zone.



Rahul. FILE PHOTO: R. V. MOORTHY

R. Kaushik

Intrigue has been a constant subtext to cricket in the subcontinent in general, and Pakistan in particular. Once volatile and unpredictable, Pakistani cricket has, in recent times, been predictably messy and controversial, the latest events in England doing little to edify its image even as it struggles to come to terms with the reality that the glory days of the past on the field are a distant memory.

The unprecedented move to banish seven players, among them two former captains, as well as the head coach and the bowling coach midway through a series has to rank among the most bizarre and knee-jerk reactions. For effect, it is perhaps overshadowed by the Pakistan Cricket Board threat to pull out of the Lord's Test of last week because the host broadcaster aired an interview with the sons of inarguably the greatest cricketer to come out of the country, Imran Khan.

Imran is a charismatic, talismanic personality who did more to raise the stock of the nation itself than anyone else. Having cut his teeth as a raw, unpolished, fiery pacer in Sussex where he was one half of a feared new-ball combine alongside South African Garth le Roux, he blossomed into a fabulous all-rounder who formed a famed quartet – alongside Ian Botham, Kapil Dev and Richard Hadlee – for much of the 1980s. With the passage of time and the inevitable onset of injuries, he dropped pace but didn't lose much by way of impact, while upping his game a notch or three as a batter as compensation.

Crowning glory

But more than as a player, Imran's legacy was cemented through his leadership abilities. His arresting presence was unmistakable on the field of play, and even when he was involved in a captaincy musical chair battle of other people's making with Javed Miandad, he was unmissable. While others congregated around the bowler to congratulate him on taking a wicket, Imran would walk regally, at his own pace, from mid-on or mid-off; as he neared the protagonist, the rest would respectfully make way for him to pat the gushing hero on the back. Imran wasn't given to grand gestures, but his wards knew that a word of praise from the skipper was worth all the riches in the world.

His crowning glory was leading Pakistan, against all odds and from the brink of elimination, to the 1992 World Cup title. The conquest of England at a raucous MCG was the ultimate vindication of his inspirational qualities and the great gift of getting his colleagues to perform above themselves, to understand and believe that nothing was beyond them. He didn't entirely endear himself to thousands of his countrymen – among them some of his own teammates – and women by focussing more on the cancer hospital he was to open in Lahore in his late mother's name instead of eulogising the historic triumph at the post-match festivities, but even his critics acknowledged that his heart was in the right place.

Imran's plunge into politics was going to be interesting, to say the least. Historically, elected Pakistani governments have operated under the iron fist of the army but Imran was his own man, so it was inevitable that there would be tension – and that's putting it mildly. His imprisonment, his deteriorating health and concerns over his well being drove Greg Chappell, the former Australian captain and one of Imran's contemporaries, to spark an initiative that involved several internationals, many of them skippers of their respective national sides including our very own Sunil Gavaskar, to make an

impassioned official plea to the Pakistani dispensation to ensure that Imran is treated with the



Among the players bundled on to the plane back home were former captains Salman and Rizwan. The former, who had led the team in the first Test in the absence of Babar, was dropped for the second game

respect he deserves and is looked after from a medical perspective. It's against this backdrop that the host broadcaster of the England-Pakistan Test series aired an interview, conducted by former England captain Mike Atherton at the Long Room, with Imran's sons Sulaiman and Kasim Khan during the Lord's Test. The Pakistan Cricket Board contemplated a boycott of the match midway before saner counsel prevailed, but that seemed to have deserted them at the conclusion of a second heavy defeat in two matches, at the end of which came the dramatic decision to recall half the team as well as Sarfaraz Ahmed, the head coach, and Umar Gul, the fast-bowling coach.

Among the players bundled on to the plane back home were former captains Salman Ali Agha and Mohammad Rizwan. Indeed, Salman had led Pakistan in the first Test in Leeds in the absence of Babar Azam, out injured; England won by an innings and 103 runs at Headingley, and once Babar was declared fit for the Lord's showdown, Salman was dumped from the playing XI for the second Test. Like Salman, Rizwan has captained the national team previously but paid the price for a middling run of scores. Also asked to fly back home was Imam-ul-Haq, the bespectacled opening batter and the nephew of revered and adored former captain Inzamam. Imam did not bat in either innings at Lord's with a low-grade calf strain which itself is now being probed, all of which has contributed to a horrible mid-series fiasco that incoming head coach Mike Hesson and Ashley Noffke, Gul's replacement, have been burdened with.

Change the only constant

Pakistan have roped in, and parted ways with, numerous leading luminaries as head coach, including Mickey Arthur, former Australia paceman Jason Gillespie and Gary Kirsten, the ex-opener from South Africa who coached India to the 50-over World Cup crown in 2011 and is now the head coach of the Sri Lankan national team. Kiwi Hesson is the latest in a long line of big-ticket names to embrace one of the most demanding tasks in world cricket, and not necessarily because

The unprecedented move to banish seven players, among them two former captains, as well as the head coach and the bowling coach midway through a series has to rank among the most bizarre and knee-jerk reactions; PCB must realise that unless it sets its house in order, the road to redemption will be strewn with thorns and boulders



GETTY IMAGES

of the pressure of expectations alone. Being the coach of the Pakistan team is not a double-edged sword; however, the sword constantly hovers overhead, despite the fact that almost all coaches have been compelled to function with one hand tied behind their back.

Pakistan's recent cricketing journey has been anything but successful. Apart from making it to the final of the T20 World Cup in Melbourne in 2022 when they were bested by England, they haven't quite matched history and expectations with performances. Their Test displays have been even more disappointing - they haven't so much as threatened to make it to the final of the World Test Championship over the first three cycles and are currently at the bottom of the nine-team standings of this latest campaign, with just 16 points from eight matches. To say that their chances of finishing in the top-two this time too are more miniscule than finding snow in the desert will be a massive understatement.

Tough road ahead

It's against this backdrop that Hesson, and Babar must embark on a journey of redemption and salvation. Neither will be unaware that for reasons beyond their control, the national team has become a laughing stock. Defeats by an innings, and by 194 runs, in seamer-friendly conditions where neither the batters nor the bowlers, with the honourable exception of Mohammad Abbas – who took nine wickets in the Lord's hammering – have covered themselves with glory, are impossible to bounce back from in a short series. While the rest of the cricketing world is bemoaning the increasing takeover of two-Test faceoffs, Pakistan would have loved for a third Test to not be there, given the unenviable position in which they find themselves.

Babar himself has been at the receiving end of selectorial vicissitudes more than once and must now find a way to rally his embattled, beleaguered troops who will look over their shoulder with a greater sense of insecurity than ever before. To lose so many key personnel in one swoop and still be expected to mount a face-saving fightback is a humongously tall task but between them, the leadership group of Babar, the best batter in the side, and Hesson have no other option. In less than a week's time, Joe Root's England, who themselves have little chance of making it to the WTC final, will be licking their lips in anticipation of a 3-0 sweep.

Fearsome attack

There was a time when England dreaded the prospect of running into Pakistan, even at home, with the imperious Wasim Akram and the toe-crushing Waqar Younis primed to wreak untold damage. So mesmerised were they with the late reverse swing the two magicians procured in 1992 that they threw unsubstantiated allegations of ball-tampering until Geoff Boycott, the straight-talking

Yorkshireman, mocked those charges by saying that the duo was so skilled that it could 'bowl England out with an orange'. It's impossible, of course, to find replacements for these legends but for a brief while, Pakistan seemed to have found a few reasonably worthy successors in Shaheen Afridi, Naseem Shah and Haris Rauf, among others. But for various reasons, no one has really taken things by the scruff of the neck and established themselves as a long-haul strike force. That, coupled with declining batting standards in all formats, have emphatically pegged Pakistan cricket back.

There is no quick fix or early solution in sight. For Pakistan to take even baby steps towards becoming a consistently competitive outfit, the first non-negotiable ingredients are faith and patience. Constant chopping and changing, of selection panels, of captains and players, and of the coaching staff, has been nothing if not counter-productive. While it will be impossible for them to replicate the Indian model, for obvious reasons, maybe they can have a look across the border to figure out what systems the Board of Control for Cricket in India has in place and how it has worked to the benefit of cricket in India. There needs to be a systemic revamp in Pakistan, at the foremost of which is a shift in thinking, in attitude and mindset. To continue to keep making the same mistakes and then hope for a different outcome is both naïve and foolhardy. The post-Lord's developments haven't done anyone any credit, and certainly not with the final act of the series due to play itself out in Birmingham from next Wednesday. Pakistan must realise that unless they set their house in order, the road to redemption will be strewn with thorns and boulders, prickly and unmovable.



THE GIST

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WORLD PHYSIOTHERAPY DAY
SEPTEMBER 8

THE HEALTH QUIZ

More than 40 crore Indians are caught in a healthcare gap: panel

(bindu.p@thehindu.co.in)